



Recruit and select staff

D1.HML.CL10.15

D1.HRM.CL9.10

D2.TRM.CL9.20

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



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& hospitality

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Recruit and select staff

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Recruit and select staff in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HML.CL10.15
D1.HRM.CL9.10
D2.TRM.CL9.20

Nominal Hours:

65 hours

Element 1: Identify staffing needs

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Obtain and read enterprise policies and procedures in relation to the staffing process
- 1.2 Identify internal factors that impact on staffing needs
- 1.3 Identify external factors that impact on staffing needs
- 1.4 Describe techniques to monitor workplace performance
- 1.5 Consult with stakeholders to determine staffing needs
- 1.6 Describe and quantify staffing requirements by position and locate them within an organisational chart
- 1.7 Undertake a job analysis of each identified position
- 1.8 Prepare job specifications and job descriptions for identified positions

Element 2: Recruit staff

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Identify and quantify positions to be advertised
- 2.2 Develop key selection criteria for each position to be advertised
- 2.3 Obtain authority to recruit staff
- 2.4 Identify sources of staff
- 2.5 Develop and lodge job advertisements/notices with identified sources of staff

Element 3: Interview staff

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Accept job applications
- 3.2 Short-list applicants
- 3.3 Check references and referees
- 3.4 Notify applicant of interview
- 3.5 Conduct job interview
- 3.6 Apply relevant testing procedures
- 3.7 File application and interview documentation

Element 4: Select staff

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Choose successful applicant/s using pre-defined criteria
- 4.2 Notify successful applicants and make formal job offer
- 4.3 Notify unsuccessful applicants
- 4.4 Follow-up as required

Element 5: Implement induction and orientation session or program

Performance Criteria

- 5.1 Plan the induction and orientation session/s
- 5.2 Conduct the induction and orientation session/s
- 5.3 Review the induction and orientation session/s

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Identify staffing needs				
1.1	Obtain and read enterprise policies and procedures in relation to the staffing process	1.1	1, 2, 3	1
1.2	Identify internal factors that impact on staffing needs	1.1	4	2
1.3	Identify external factors that impact on staffing needs	1.1	5	3
1.4	Describe techniques to monitor workplace performance	1.1	6, 7, 8	4
1.5	Consult with stakeholders to determine staffing needs	1.1	9	5
1.6	Describe and quantify staffing requirements by position and locate them within an organisational chart	1.1	10, 11, 12	6
1.7	Undertake a job analysis of each identified position	1.2	13, 14, 15	7
1.8	Prepare job specifications and job descriptions for identified positions	1.2	16, 17, 18	8
Element 2: Recruit staff				
2.1	Identify and quantify positions to be advertised	-	19, 20, 21	9
2.2	Develop key selection criteria for each position to be advertised	2.1	22	10
2.3	Obtain authority to recruit staff	2.1	23	11
2.4	Identify sources of staff	2.1	24	12

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
2.5	Develop and lodge job advertisements/notices with identified sources of staff	2.1	25	13
Element 3: Interview staff				
3.1	Accept job applications	3.1	26	14
3.2	Short-list applicants	3.1	27, 28	15
3.3	Check references and referees	3.1	29, 30	16
3.4	Notify applicant of interview	3.1	31	17
3.5	Conduct job interview	3.1	32, 33	18
3.6	Apply relevant testing procedures	3.1	34	19
3.7	File application and interview documentation	3.1	35	20
Element 4: Select staff				
4.1	Choose successful applicant/s using pre-defined criteria	4.1	36, 37	21
4.2	Notify successful applicants and make formal job offer	4.1	38	22
4.3	Notify unsuccessful applicants	4.1	39	23
4.4	Follow-up as required	4.1	40	24
Element 5: Implement induction and orientation session or program				
5.1	Plan the induction and orientation session/s	5.1	41, 42	25
5.2	Conduct the induction and orientation session/s	5.1	43	26
5.3	Review the induction and orientation session/s	5.1	44, 45	27

Glossary

Term	Explanation
AGM	Annual General Meeting
CV	<i>Curriculum Vitae</i> – a resumé
Deportment	The way a person moves and carries themselves; the way they walk and behave
EO	Equal Opportunity
KSC	Key Selection Criteria
KPI	Key Performance Indicator – a way of determining the performance level of an employee
Maître d'	Maître d'hôtel (French) = Master of the hotel; the Head Waiter in charge of the dining room
Multi-skilling	Having skills in more than one employment area/job position
OHS	Occupational Safety and Health. OSH refers to 'Occupational Safety and Health'. In some countries the term OSH 'Occupational Safety and Health' is used. The concept is identical and relates to workplace health and safety policies, procedures and practices
PD	Position Description
PR	Public Relations
Poaching staff	The unacceptable practice of one business 'stealing' staff from another employer by making them a job offer promising, for example, more money, better conditions, a promotion
Remuneration	Pay or wages. The money paid to staff for work performed
SME	Small-Medium size Enterprise
SMS	Short Message Service
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
Sommelier	Very experienced wine waiter. Head wine waiter
YTD	Year to date

Element 1: Identify staffing needs

1.1 Obtain and read enterprise policies and procedures in relation to the staffing process

Introduction

No effective action in relation to the recruitment and selection of staff can occur until the enterprise policies and procedures relating to the staffing process are understood.

This Section identifies common staffing policies and procedures with which you may have to comply and indicates how these policies may be obtained.

Staffing policies and procedures

Variances between individual operations

Staffing policies and procedures can be expected to vary between businesses based on:

- Their previous experiences with staff recruitment and selection. Previous experience will influence what is contained in the policies and procedures.

The current policies will be drafted to prevent repeating mistakes made before.

- The size of the business. Smaller businesses tend to be more informal while larger businesses tend to be more regimented
- Personal preferences of the owner. An owner-operated business will reflect the personal orientations of the owner
- Legal requirements applying to individual business types and/or industry sectors to ensure compliance with relevant employment laws.



Sample policies and procedures

Depending on the enterprise the following policies and procedures may be in place in your workplace:

Job advertising

This may address:

- Information that may and may not be included in a job advertisement. Some employers:
 - Will not want the name of their business included in advertisements so applicants and others do not know who is advertising for staff
 - Will not want their telephone number included to avoid the need to respond to numerous calls enquiring about the job

- Will not want their address included to prevent applicants calling in-person to make enquiries
- The newspapers in which job advertisements are to be lodged, including:
 - Type and size of advertisements
 - Use of company logo
 - Days of the week the advertisement is to run
 - Duration of advertising period – for example, one week or a fortnight
- Job recruitment agencies to be used and the information to be given to them about the vacancy
- Online recruitment to be undertaken – websites to be used and not to be used.

Internal staff promotions

This may address:

- A statement that all vacant positions must be advertised externally
- A statement the enterprise will attempt to fill all vacant positions from within before advertising externally
- Criteria for determining whether a job should be advertised externally or not.

Staff training

This will cover:

- The basic induction training all new employees are required to undertake on joining the enterprise
- Pre-requisite or mandatory training for nominated positions to ensure staff have:
 - Complied with legally imposed training and/or certification requirements
 - Learned the necessary basic skills and knowledge to enable them to discharge their designated tasks and responsibilities. This may include:
 - Customer service skills
 - Technical work such as operating equipment and systems
 - Completing documentation
 - Cash handling
 - Workplace security
 - Occupational health and security
- The commitment of the enterprise towards training in terms of time allowed for staff to undertake training and training costs the enterprise will pay for if staff attend external training.



Remuneration

This may provide details on:

- Pay rates for different staff on an hourly, weekly, fortnightly or annual basis
- Overtime payments including when they apply
- Pay rates for holiday periods and any designated 'penalty periods' (which may include weekend work, late night work, early morning work).



Probationary period

The probationary period occurs when a new employee starts work with an employer.

It is commonly a three month period during which:

- The employer can determine whether or not they are going to continue employing the new staff member
- The new employee is 'on probation'. Their work and they themselves are under scrutiny to see if they measure up
- The employer is entitled to dismiss them without being concerned about unfair dismissal accusations being levelled at them
- The employee can elect to leave the employer.

Some enterprises do not have probationary periods, and some have periods longer than three months.

Terms and conditions of employment

These set out the working conditions of the staff such as:

- When they are entitled to rest breaks and meal breaks
- Length of the working day – hours worked per week
- Entitlements to sick leave pay
- Holiday entitlements and annual leave
- Superannuation.

Benefits

Not all enterprises offer 'benefits' to workers.

Where benefits are offered:

- There is usually a qualifying period. Commonly the employee must have completed their probation period, or have worked for one year
- They may relate to:
 - Discounts when buying enterprise products or services
 - Access to certain products or services in the workplace
 - Additional training or opportunities
 - Workplace awards and rewards for effort or achievement

General staff behaviour and presentation

There is commonly a raft of policies dictating management expectations in relation to:

- Uniform – wearing of uniform, cleaning and laundering of uniform, replacement of uniform
- Personal presentation covering requirements in relation to personal hygiene, hair, facial hair, wearing of make-up and jewellery, grooming and deportment
- Smoking. Some businesses will ban smoking totally during work hours, some venues will require staff to brush their teeth or use mints after smoking and before serving customers
- Tact and diplomacy. This is especially important for staff who have direct contact with customers and the common requirement is all employees are expected to use tact and discretion when dealing with all people (including suppliers/providers, agents, other staff)



Sickness. Every enterprise will require staff to notify the business as soon as possible if they are unable to attend work for any reason, including illness.

Some enterprises may require staff who are unable to work due to illness to provide a medical certificate proving they were ill.

In food handling situations, many employers require those directly involved in the handling of food (other than food in sealed containers) to supply a medical certificate stating that as a food worker they are fit to return to work and food handling duties.

- Attendance and punctuality. Most venues will require employees to:
 - Come to work on time as indicated by the official roster
 - Remain at work until their rostered time for breaks or departure
 - Work reasonable amounts of overtime as requested by their employer
 - Not leave work when dealing with a customer
 - Notify management as soon as possible if unable to attend work for any reason
- Use of company property. Most venues prohibit staff from using company property for personal use or gain. This means:
 - Workplace telephones cannot be used for private calls
 - Workplace computers and internet cannot be used for private purposes
 - Products and services (such as but not limited to food, beverages, stationery, tickets, complimentary guest items) cannot be used or taken by staff. This is regarded as stealing and may lead to instant dismissal and criminal prosecution.

Composition of interview and selection panels

Enterprises often provide explicit direction regarding:

- The number of people who must be present when a job interview is conducted. The number may vary with the level and type of job for which the interview is being conducted

- The experience and/or position of those who are to comprise the interview panel
- The role to be played by each person on the panel.

Designated authorities for hiring staff

When job interviews have been conducted and a decision has been made about who to hire, a recommendation may need to be passed to a higher authority (such as the business owner or manager) so they can make the final hiring decision.

Policies and procedures in this regard may stipulate:

- Timeframe for notification
- Information/documentation to accompany the recommendation such as CV, results of tests administered, interview sheets
- Nominated persons with authority to make the ultimate hiring decision.



Discretionary power

In some enterprises nominated people (such as Supervisors, Department Managers and Heads of Divisions) may be given discretionary power to make on the spot decisions in an interview situation (or as part of employment negotiations) to:

- Negotiate remuneration with individual applicants where, for example, the enterprise wants to engage an applicant who appears reluctant and/or who has skills, experience and ability the business desperately wants to obtain
- Negotiate conditions of employment which may embrace issues such as:
 - Bonuses – sometimes linked to negotiated KPIs
 - Days and hours of work
 - Benefits which can cover a wide range of items depending on the job (such as travel, a car, telephone allowance, uniform/dress allowance, accommodation, subscription to magazines, attendance at conferences).

Legislation

All enterprises will make statements requiring their operations to align with relevant in-country legislation at it applies to matters such as:

- Industrial relations – setting out the protocols for dealing with industrial disputes and pay claims
- Equal opportunity and diversity – to ensure workers are free from discrimination in relation to:
 - Employment
 - Promotion
 - Training
 - Discipline
 - Dismissal.
 - Employers will want staff to be treated fairly regardless of their age, ethnicity, gender or age
- Registration for taxation, insurance and superannuation and payment of relevant premiums and contributions.

Why is this knowledge important?

It is important you understand enterprise policies and procedures because they provide guidance for your thinking and action, and give parameters within which you are expected to operate.

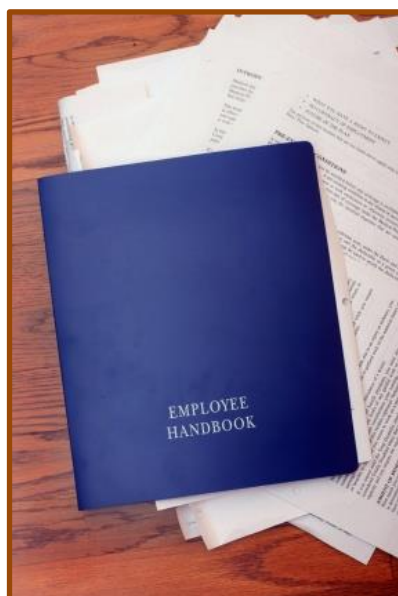
A sound knowledge will:

- Enable you to make decisions in relation to staff recruitment and selection through knowing what you are allowed to do and what you are not allowed to do
- Allow you to answer questions about employment at your workplace such as those asked by job applicants and staff seeking promotion or management who question your decisions
- Ensure your staffing activities align with enterprise requirements which are embodied in the policies and procedures and which, in turn, reflect the strategic goals and direction of the enterprise.

Understanding enterprise policies and procedures

You can obtain a detailed understanding of the policies and procedures at your workplace by a combination of the following approaches:

- Reading hard copy policies and procedures provided by the enterprise such as in Employee Handbooks and Policy and Procedure Manuals
- Accessing the intranet of enterprises where internal company information is available electronically
- Attending internal training sessions focussing on interpreting and applying enterprise policies and procedures
- Talking to Managers and more experienced staff to gain an appreciation of their understanding of what is required
- Asking questions to help understand any ambiguous aspects.



1.2 Identify internal factors that impact on staffing needs

Introduction

Before staff are hired or dismissed there must be an analysis of internal and external factors impacting the business and the need for staff.

Whenever staff are engaged or made redundant, there must be a valid reason for that action.

This Section identifies internal issues to be considered when making this determination.

Budget

Budget must always be considered in relation to staffing.

It is important you identify the wages/labour parameters within which you are expected to operate.

Your labour budget may be a figure. This may be per day, per week, or per annum.



More commonly you will be set a 'percentage of sales' figure. This will allow you to hire more staff as you generate more revenue. The specific percentage allocated will depend on the establishment and relate to factors such as service ethos, and the return they require on the money invested.

The percentages may also vary between departments. For instance, the percentage labour figure in retail bottle shops will traditionally be lower than for bars because of the lower profit margin associated with packaged liquor sales.

In some establishments, you will have the ability to 'mix and match' to suit your own needs and your personal style. This means you can 'borrow' some money from Department X this week, to help balance out the wages spent in Department Y, providing the *overall budget* comes in on target.

In some instances, a saving on wages this week can be used at a later time to subsidise a high labour period.

In other cases, each department is judged as a stand alone unit, and the requirement is each and every labour budget comes in within the prescribed limits.

This situation may mean the owner or manager has to do more work themselves in order to minimise wages.

The point is *your* performance as a manager will often be assessed by your ability to manage the wages (labour) budget. It is relatively easy to increase actual sales, but the real demonstration of ability is to maximise the net profit, and keeping the labour costs under control is an essential aspect of this.

You should also determine what effect public holidays (where wage rates are usually higher, per hour) have on your wages budget. Are you expected to return usual percentages, even when the period contains one or two public holiday (that is, penalty rate) days? Or are you given extra funds to accommodate these higher labour costs?

Can you charge higher selling prices at these times to recoup extra labour costs?

This highlights the fact you must know the rules of the game, you must know how your performance is being judged, and one of the key KPIs is your ability to manage the labour budget.

A key factor is knowing with complete certainty exactly how much you have to spend on wages.

Existing staff

In relation to the staff currently working at the venue you must know:

- The staff you have working for you by name, by their experience and expertise, by their background and by their ability
- The numbers of staff working for you in terms of individual workers and the number of hours they work per day/week.

Unless you know these facts you cannot hope to manage your staffing requirements.



To determine the operational effectiveness and competency of staff:

- Observe them at work
- Set them trade challenges/tests
- Read their resumé
- Talk to their co-workers
- Talk to the customers they serve.

Your determinations in this regard needs to:

- Highlight who is competent and who is not so training or other action (retrenchment) can be considered
- Identify employees who may be in excess of current demand and who may need to be retrained to another job, reallocated to another position or retrenched
- Identify hours being worked (paid for) that are not necessary so rosters can be revised to better reflect actual workplace demand
- Identify individuals who may be suitable for multi-skilling and/or promotion.

Service standards

It is critical you know and understand the service standards for the enterprise or department where you work.

Staffing is very much a balancing act. On the one hand you are trying to minimise the amount spent on wages while on the other hand you are trying to maximise the level of service to customers.

Insufficient staff numbers can mean a lower level of wages, but also a lower level of service. If this lower level of service is continued, this can mean a further reduced level of trade and the business enters into a downward spiral.

Excessive staff increase wages to an unacceptable level, and will not necessarily guarantee higher levels of service.

It is essential you talk to management to identify service standards they deem important for your area.

For example:

- Management may have a ratio of one staff member for every 20 guests in a dining area and this may be non-negotiable
- Standard procedure may require two people at Reception regardless of the level of trade, and the number of expected check-ins or check-outs
- The enterprise may insist there is always a receptionist present to greet customers when they walk into the business
- Policy may dictate no customer waits for longer than 30 seconds before being greeted, or having their order taken.

These non-negotiable elements of the business will have an obvious impact on staffing levels and the way the roster is prepared.

Trading hours

The hours the business opens and shuts, and the trading hours of individual departments within the business are significant internal factors impacting on staffing levels and requirements.



It is useful to consider 'staggering' starting and finishing times of staff as a way of reducing labour costs.

For example:

- If the business opens at 9:00AM, instead of bringing all staff in at the one time:
 - Bring one staff member on at 8:45AM to set up and open
 - Bring the next in at 9:30AM as trade gradually increases
 - Bring the other staff in at 11:45AM as trade reaches its peak
- If the business closes at 6:00PM, instead of releasing all staff at 6:15PM:
 - Let some staff go home at 4:00PM as trade decreases
 - Send more home at 5:00PM or 5:30PM
 - Keep only one staff member back till 6:30PM to close up and clean up.

Volume of customers

The aim should be to match the number of staff to the number of customers needing to be served.

Proper staffing is often referred to as the 'art of having the right people, in the right place, in the right numbers, at the right time.'

Note you need to realise the aim of this focus is 'to serve the customer' as distinct from 'take money'.

In many cases, there will be a need for staff to be working even where no immediate revenue is generated, such as when:

- Providing sales advice which may or may not result in a sale
- Promoting products and services where the intention may be to raise awareness as opposed to generate sales
- Providing service expected by customers as part of something they have already purchased. For example, security and maintenance is expected by customers when they buy an accommodation package but these departments do not generate revenue, as such.

Peak demands

Most businesses have peaks and troughs in their trade and you must know what they are for your business or department in order to be effective and efficient in the rostering of staff.

These peaks and troughs may be able to be identified:

- On a hourly basis. Most businesses have times of the day when they are busy and when they are quiet
- On a daily basis. Many businesses have certain days of the week that are busy and others which are slow
- On a seasonal basis. This may be due to festivals, holiday periods, international trade or weather.

In theory there should be more staff available or rostered when demands on the business are greatest, but:

- Service standards must be considered. If a waiting time of three minutes before being attended to by a sales adviser is acceptable then the level of staff needs to reflect this rather than provide an 'immediate' service with no waiting
- Low demand periods should reflect correspondingly reduced staffing levels. It is inadvisable to only consider 'peak' demand without identifying and responding to low demand times.

Nature and type of customers

The customers your business attracts and services are also influential when considering internal factors impacting on staffing.

Issues to be considered in this regard include:

- Safety. Most businesses require a minimum of two staff after a certain time at night for the safety of employees
- Whether alcohol is involved. Where liquor service and consumption occurs this can indicate:
 - A need for more staff
 - A need for security staff



- Age of customers. Where young people are targeted there can be a need for more staff because:
 - They tend to spend more than other customers
 - They demand faster service
 - They tend to cause more problems in liquor venues
- The potential for repeat business. Where there is a chance the current customers will become repeat customers, venues tend to provide more staff to provide quicker service. Where customers are not expected to become repeat customers, there can be a case for the provision of fewer staff meaning slower service
- Business people demand more prompt attention than other customers because their time is more valuable. This needs to be taken into account where the enterprise or department serves a significant proportion of business people.



The business itself

There is always a need to consider the business itself when identifying internal factors impacting on staffing.

Important considerations are:

- Directions the business wishes to take. This relates to departures from their past activities in terms of:
 - Target markets. New/different markets require new/different skill sets from staff
 - Service levels and standards. Higher service standards generally require more staff and/or better trained staff
 - Services and products provided. An increased number or type of products and services requires staff with commensurate skills to provide them
- The existing reputation and image of the business. In general (unless the business has set itself new directions, or been taken over by new owners/management) most enterprises will seek to maintain their reputation and image, meaning:
 - Great attention needs to be paid to monitoring changes in staffing levels to determine how these are impacting on customer perceptions about service delivery. Are customers still happy with service levels? Or have they noticed a drop in standards since one less staff member was rostered to serve them?
 - Special attention needs to be paid to staffing levels (and personnel) when new opposition businesses open up, and when existing competition businesses launch a new promotional campaign. It is often at these times when your existing customers can be persuaded to leave you and try the other business, especially if your service is sub-standard.

Service offered

In food and beverage outlets there is always a need to consider the service style being offered to patrons when looking at internal staffing issues.

The more sophisticated the service style, the more staff will be required. This applies to fine dining restaurants and functions.

For example:

- Plated service is the most common service style where food is placed on to plates in the kitchen and carried to the tables by waiting staff
- Silver service is a high quality service style requiring more staff (and crockery, cutlery and equipment) where an empty plate is placed in front of the guest and food is silver served (using tongs or spoon and fork) from service trays on to the individual guest plates
- Gueridon service includes (but is not limited to) the cooking of dishes at the table and the silver service of vegetables, sauces and garnishes on to individual guest plates at the table
- Smorgasbords or buffets allow, or require, guests to serve themselves. This service style can require less waiting staff but may not be exactly what your target market wants in terms of food service.

Equipment used

There is a need to ensure sufficient suitably trained and competent staff to operate whatever systems, technology or equipment are in use at the venue.

Factors involved are:

- The need for sufficient original training and update training as required
- The need to train sufficient numbers to ensure the systems, technology or equipment can be operated when required. This may be seven days a week in some cases
- The need for trained staff in order to meet:
 - Warranty and guarantee requirements
 - Compliance requirements
 - Safety and insurance requirements
- The need for planned transitions from existing systems, technology or equipment to new systems, technology or equipment, allowing time for staff to become familiar with new or upgraded items.



Promises made

Staffing provision must always enable the enterprise to keep any promises made to customers or potential customers.

This relates to:

- Specific promises made to customers when they, for example:
 - Buy a package
 - Book a function
 - Purchase a product or service.



In effect, these promises are part of a contract the business has entered into with the customer and there is a legal obligation on the enterprise to meet its commitments in this regard

- Promises made in advertisements and which are regarded at law, and by customers, as inducements to buy. This means:
 - Care must be taken when making promises to customers/potential customers. The industry standard is to 'under-promise and over-deliver'
 - The enterprise can never promise anything and everything simply to make a sale – you can only promise what you are able and prepared to deliver on
 - You must not promise skilled staff if they are not competent
 - You cannot promise quick service if there are insufficient staff to enable this
 - You must not advertise 'We speak English' if there are no English-speaking staff on duty.

Coverage of known or expected staff movement

You must always be alert to predictable staff movements and requirements, and aware of the potential for unpredictable staff movement.

Predictable staff movement

You must plan to cover staff absences where:

- They are due for leave such as long service leave, annual leave or any other form of leave for which employees need to submit an 'application for leave'
- They are scheduled to attend training sessions and they need to be back-filled
- They have requested time off for family or personal reasons
- There is ongoing sick leave due to injury or illness
- You know staff are due to leave the business to work elsewhere and/or retire
- Staff from one department are being promoted to another position on a temporary or permanent basis.

Options for addressing these situations include:

- Doing extra work yourself
- Asking other staff to work extra hours

- Accepting reduced service levels and operating with reduced staff numbers
- Calling in alternative staff for a pool of people who have already been interviewed and who you know can effectively do the required work.

Unpredictable staff movement

There will always be unpredictable staff movement so, knowing this, you should have a 'Plan B' ready for these situations.

Unpredictable staff movement can occur when:

- Staff are injured at work and have to go home or seek medical attention
- Staff fail to attend for work when rostered including situations where they are late for work
- Staff have to leave work to take care of a family or personal emergency
- Staff are injured or delayed on the way to work.

Your preparation should develop a Plan B that identifies:

- The immediate, short-term response to the situation – see 'options for addressing these situations' above
- A more permanent solution to the problem which may include advertising for staff, transferring existing staff to other duties, or promoting and/or cross-training (multi-skilling) certain workers.

Motivating and retaining staff is often related to their employment status and recognition and may take the form of extra pay or promotion. However what motivates staff can vary from one employee to another.

Categorising the workforce

Employees may be categorised as:

- Permanent – working a full week (as defined by local industrial instruments): entitlements may include sick pay and annual leave
- Part-time – working above a minimum number of hours per week but less than the hours worked by a permanent employee: they receive *pro rata* entitlements
- Trainees – who work a set number of hours per work with additional hours allocated for study of vocational training: their rate of pay is relatively low
- Casual – paid on an hourly basis, per engagement: they receive a relatively high hourly rate but no entitlements
- Volunteers – who work free-of-charge
- Contract – who work under the agreed conditions of an employment contract.

Motivating staff

Effective motivation of staff must address issues valued by individual staff – what motivates one person may not motivate another.

One employee may value time off whereas another may seek extra money.



With this in mind, motivation of workers may be achieved through using one or more of the following approaches:

- Performance bonuses
 - Annual pay rises – which may be linked to performance
 - Additional pay for additional qualifications/experience
 - Time off
 - In-house awards – ‘Employee of the Month’
 - Internal promotion of staff to higher positions when vacancies become available
 - Cross-training of staff into new or higher areas
 - Involving workers in management decisions
 - Attendance at industry events, seminars and conferences
 - Paid formal training
 - Implementation of Personal Growth and Development Plans for individual workers.
- Formal recognition of good work in the form of a letter of acknowledgement and thanks or even a word of praise can be a powerful motivator for many staff.

1.3 Identify external factors that impact on staffing needs

Introduction

As already mentioned there must be sound reasons for hiring or firing staff

This Section identifies external issues to be considered when making this decision.

The external business environment

When considering your staffing needs you must always look outside the organisation and an important consideration is the external business environment in which the enterprise is operating in.

Of particular importance are the following:

- Evaluation and analysis of the competition. Questions to be answered include:
 - Is competition growing, staying the same or decreasing?
 - What activities are being undertaken by the competition to increase their market share and/or take custom from you?
 - Are they cutting prices?

- Are they advertising more?
- Are they offering a new or better service and/or products?
- What does it appear you need to do to combat this opposition activity? Is the answer really a staffing response (more staff, more qualified staff, more personable staff, more competent staff). Is the answer totally unrelated to staffing and another approach is required (lower prices, increased value for money, better inclusions in packages).
- The state of the economy taking into consideration:
 - Local employment rates
 - Availability of credit
 - Exchange rates
 - Levels of disposable income
- Consideration of the countries and economies of the countries from which customers are drawn. Where the enterprise relies heavily on revenue from international customers, the state of their currency and economy are important issues to take into account.

In some cases these elements are of more importance to staffing levels than the local economy.

Customer expectations

All businesses should strive to be customer-focussed meaning all their efforts should be concentrated on delivering products and services deemed by the customers to be important *to them*.

This is directly opposite to the approach taken by the decreasing number of businesses who adopt a self-focussed approach, believing they know what their customers want and what is best for them.

Being customer-focussed is a very marketing oriented way to do business and requires the enterprise to engage in some form of market research. Even basic market research techniques can help a business stay in touch with its customers and determine what it is they need, want and/or prefer.

Ways to capture information from your customers (that is, ways to undertake basic market research) include:

- Talking to customers to get their input and feedback
- Make available 'Customer Comment' cards for customers to complete and encourage them to fill them in, and read them when they are submitted
- Have a 'Contact Us' facility on your website
- Use focus groups to discuss targeted issues
- Pay attention to complaints made and compliments given
- Produce and administer questionnaires
- Observe customers – look at their body language and listen to comments they make.



Emerging trends

Business operates in a dynamic environment, meaning it is constantly changing.

Many of the needs, wants and preferences of customers *yesterday* are not the same *today*.

This means customers have evolving needs and the enterprise needs to be alert to identifying emerging trends.



Whenever a business can identify an emerging trend they can capitalise on it by offering products and services best meeting those new or revised needs.

Examples of emerging trends across the industry (all of which have potential impact on staffing) are:

- Increase in international travel and tourism
- Increase in frequent short holidays rather than a single, longer duration holiday
- Increase in women who are travelling for business
- Growth in new tourism markets such as eco-tourism, action tourism, medical tourism.

Relationship between 'Customer expectations' and 'Emerging trends'

There is a strong relationship between 'Customer expectations' and 'Emerging trends'. You must be alert to market research findings indicating your customers or potential customers want:

- More staff or fewer staff (some customers may want to be left alone)
- Staff with different attributes – skills, knowledge, attitudes, language
- Staff at different times such as meal times, check-in and check-out, certain days of the week or times of the day, week, month or year.

Changes in legislation and technology

Legislation

Changes in legislation have the potential to impact on staffing as follows:

- There can be a need to train staff about the new legislation – what it means to their everyday workplace responsibilities, what new/different compliance obligations are provided for, and how their work needs to change to comply
- There can be a need for staff to obtain mandatory licences, certificates or qualifications
- There may be a need for staff to update or refresh existing licences, certificates or qualifications
- There may be a need for staff to provide evidence they have completed mandatory training/courses
- Staff who were previously employed in a legal capacity may need to be removed from their position where legislation means, for example, their age prohibits them from working as a result of legislative changes, or their qualification is now deemed to be out of date, or no longer recognised by authorities.

Technology

Where there have been changes in technology the implications for staff could include:

- The need for training, certification and experience on the new equipment, technology or systems. This may involve:
 - In-house training
 - External training by a private training provider
 - Arrangements with suppliers for them to provide on-site training and commissioning of the new system/equipment
- The need for staff to be able to explain new equipment, technology or systems to customers and help them use it
- The need for integrating existing work practices into the requirements of the new equipment, technology or systems.

Availability of staff

For some positions in some industry sectors there are lots of suitable staff available. These staff either have the necessary basic skills and knowledge, or can be readily trained as required. They may or may not have industry experience.

For some other positions, or in different countries or regions, there can be a scarcity of suitable job applicants.

You need to determine the nature and size of potential staff available to fill your vacancies.

A lack of suitable local staff may mean:

- You have to advertise internationally or out of your local area
- You need to simplify the tasks in order that less qualified or experienced people can undertake them
- You need to offer more money to attract suitable applicants
- You need to improve working conditions
- There is a need to offer more on-site/in-house training to develop a body of suitable trained staff
- A need to work with authorities, local employer bodies and agencies to:
 - Promote vocational training
 - Encourage people to engage with vocational training
 - Offer more vocational training
 - Facilitate the movement of trained, experienced and qualified people into the local industry.



1.4 Describe techniques to monitor workplace performance

Introduction

The study of workplace performance is a field in its own right.

This Section introduces techniques available to provide an overview of what you may use to help determine staffing needs based on individual staff performance.

Why monitor workplace performance?

It is important for you to monitor the workplace performance of your staff to:

- Identify those who need help, training or support
- Help determine whether actual outcomes are person-based or related to other issues such as poor layout, malfunctioning equipment, ineffective SOPs
- Identify good performance so it can be recognised and/or rewarded
- Identify staff who may be suitable for promotion or to undertake extra responsibilities or a new job/position
- Remind staff their performance at work is under scrutiny which encourages them to perform at their best.

Statistical analysis

Statistical analysis involves:

- Determining 'expected' (or 'projected') figures for labour which may include consideration of a multitude of staff-related expenditures and associated issues such as:
 - Wage costs
 - Training costs
 - Uniform costs
 - Number of staff employed/hours worked
 - Number of staff achieving nominated licences, certificates or qualifications in a given period
- Calculating the 'actual' figures for the nominated areas based on actual information and data
- Comparing 'expected' figures against 'actual' figures to determine the extent to which targets were achieved.



Labour cost percentage

Venues can use 'labour cost percentage' as a statistical analysis and a way to check on labour costs compared to sales/revenue.

Labour cost percentage identifies the percentage of revenue that represent the cost of labour to generate those sales.

Labour cost percentage is calculated by dividing the labour cost (for the enterprise, or an individual department) by the sales for the enterprise (or department), and multiplying by 100 over 1.



That is:

$$\frac{\text{Labour cost}}{\text{Sales}} \times \frac{100}{1}$$

Assume: Sales 8550 and Labour Costs 2250

Labour cost percentage would be calculated as follows:

$$\frac{2250}{8550} \times \frac{100}{1} = 26.3\%$$

The labour cost percentage for these figures is thus 26.3%.

In the above example, if management had set a labour cost percentage target of 30%, you would be happy because you have come in under budget.

If the target was 25%, then you would have come in slightly over budget.

These calculations may be done before the roster is put in place (to make sure it is within budget), and then the same calculations are done *after* the period, using the *actual* figures that have emerged, to see how the costed roster compared to the actual roster. This allows anything over budget to be identified and factored in to the next roster – meaning cut-backs will probably have to be made.

If labour cost percentage is too high then this may indicate:

- There are too many staff
- The way they are rostered is inefficient. Staff are being paid excessive overtime and/or penalty rates because they are being asked to work hours outside those normally provided for
- Revenue has not matched expectations. You have not attracted the customers/sales you believed you would do for the period in question
- Insufficient allocation of funds for labour. In reality, the department or workplace may be under-resourced in terms of staff and the work they are expected to do and the standard they are expected to maintain
- An unexpected workplace event resulting in a situation where staff have had to be paid overtime/penalty rates
- Public holidays which may require the business to pay higher hourly rates to staff.

Qualitative and quantitative analysis

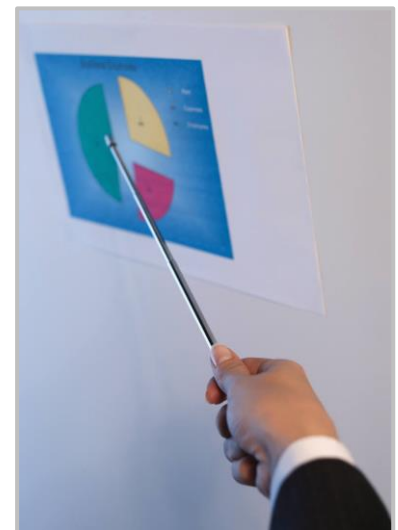
Quantitative and qualitative analysis compares statistical data against soft data, as distinct from, for example, labour cost percentage which is a purely statistical comparison/analysis.

This style of analysis may consider issues such as:

- Level of absenteeism compared to different staffing levels. Asking questions such as 'Is the high workload when staffing levels have been cut causing staff to stay away from work?'
- Level of staff departure – 'Are reduced staffing levels forcing staff to leave and go and work elsewhere?'
- Type of customer complaints when staffing levels are varied – 'Is there a reduction in complaints or a change in the nature of the complaints when extra staff are employed?'
- Wastage – 'is there more/less waste when staffing levels change?' 'Are different things wasted?'
- Damage – 'What happens to levels and types of damage done to workplace equipment when staffing levels change?'

The basics of conducting a qualitative and quantitative analysis are:

- Obtain baseline data from the venue or department for a known situation where staff levels, workload and revenue is known. This data should cover:
 - Quantitative data – figures, statistics, percentages, totals, ratios
 - Qualitative data – input as a result of discussions with staff and customers
- Compare this data to data produced when staffing levels change and analyse the changes
- Determine 'cause and effect' results identifying how changes to staff levels impact nominated concerns or workplace issues.



Benchmarking

Benchmarking is the process of identifying the best practices and standards existing anywhere in the world that apply to your industry/operation, and comparing what happens in your workplace against that 'benchmark'.

This is referred to as external benchmarking.

Internal benchmarking refers to using the same approach but comparing current evidence against previous evidence from your enterprise, or against data from other properties in the chain to which your venue belongs.

The results of the comparison provide the basis for remedial, or other action, as required so the organisation can attain the standard represented by the adopted benchmark.

Benchmarking is very popular and effective as it is one way of judging the organisation against the reality of the marketplace, and against previous performance.

Benchmarking could be used to monitor staff performance as follows:

- Comparing the number of rooms serviced by your room attendants against the number of room serviced by room attendants in another venue
- Comparing the number of customers or tables served by the waiting staff at your venue against the statistics for service provided across the chain by Head Office
- Comparing the number or value sales made by staff against statistics released by an industry peak body or as a result of research by a government agency.

Informal and formal research

This technique requires you to do one or both of the following:

- Make a conscious effort to capture feedback provided by customers. This refers to unsolicited feedback provided (for example):
 - When talking with customers
 - Overheard from guest conversations
 - Provided on Customer Comment cards, or on your website
 - In the form of compliments and/or complaints
- Deliberately investigate matters relevant to identified staffing issues. This may include:
 - Using focus groups to discuss service levels at different staffing levels
 - Observing with a specific focus the service delivery provided by staff at different staffing levels to identify how changes in staff levels impact, for example, on interpersonal skills used by workers, the guest/customer experience, delays in service
 - Reading trade magazines and research reports relating to staffing and its relation to a variety of issues such as service standards, repeat business, customer satisfaction, staff and/or customer attrition rates.



1.5 Consult with stakeholders to determine staffing needs

Introduction

From time to time, it can be beneficial and/or necessary to consult with 'other stakeholders' in relation to staffing needs.

This Section identifies who these stakeholders might be and looks at the perspective they can bring to deliberations about staffing needs.

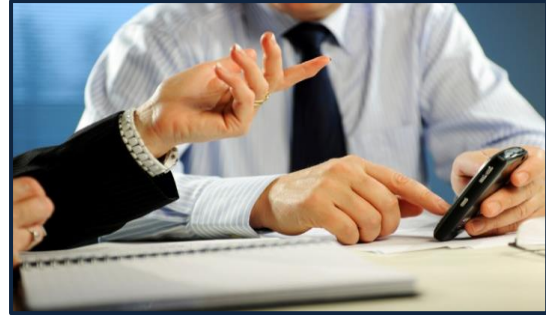
Owners

Many SMEs are owner-operated and it is often the owner who makes all or most of the operational decisions regarding the business.

Some of these decisions are based on sound reason, facts and strategic thinking, and many others are based on whim or simple personal preference or an individual desire to do something, or not do something.

Owners should be consulted in relation to staff because they may:

- Know the financial state of the business and whether or not it can afford to hire extra staff, or whether it needs to shed staff
- Have a personal desire to get rid of a certain staff member and replace them with someone else they have identified
- Have a plan to take the business in a new direction which could have implications for numbers of staff required, their experience and skill sets.



Where you work for an owner-operator it is a sound plan to meet regularly with this person to share concerns and ideas.

A meeting once per week is good – a daily meeting is even better.

Board of Directors

The Board of Directors has responsibility for the long-term performance and viability of the business. The day to day running of the enterprise rests with managers and middle level management.

The Board of Directors should be consulted in relation to staffing needs because:

- They will know the strategic plans, goals and objectives for the business and your staffing efforts must align with and support these. For example, they may be:
 - Downsizing the business because of concerns about the state of the economy or other considerations
 - Expanding the business on the basis of various identified opportunities
 - Changing the positioning of the business in the marketplace requiring a different approach in terms of staff attitude, experience and capability
 - Introducing new departments, products, services or facilities into the venue requiring staff with new/different skill sets
- You may be required to make a formal presentation to the Board on nominated occasions such as at all Board Meetings, specified meetings or the AGM
- They may need to approve certain staffing plans after they have analysed them
- The labour budget is frequently one of the biggest, ongoing expenses any enterprise runs so they have a distinct interest in how these budgets are performing:
 - Against projections
 - Against same time, last year figures
 - Against revenue
 - By comparison with other properties in the same chain
 - In total – on a YTD basis.

Shareholders

Shareholders may be public or private.

Public shareholders are those who have bought shares in the business on the Stock Exchange. It will never be your job to report to these people, or consult with them. The Board of Directors will do this.

Private shareholders are individuals who have a stake in the business. They are often family of the person who founded the business, friends or selected investors.

You may need to consult with these people when:

- Significant events relating to staffing are being considered such as:
 - Large scale redundancies
 - Response to a major industrial relations issue
 - Across the board pay rises
 - Costly alterations or improvements to working conditions
- The reputation and/or image of the enterprise is likely to be impacted by the staffing decisions being considered because their personal image and reputation is directly linked to that of the business
- A staffing issue arises with the potential to gain external attention and impact on how 'the public' regard the enterprise. This may be an unfair dismissal allegation, an allegation of harassment or an alleged breach of EO legislation and requirements.

These people should be consulted because:

- It is their money at risk and they are therefore entitled to an opinion
- They can have ultimate authority to approve or reject your plan/s
- They may be able to provide valuable alternate insight into an issue and contribute a new/different way of thinking throwing a fresh perspective on a topic.

Senior management

Senior management can include:

- Department managers
- Division or section managers
- Nominated managers from Head Office.

Supervisors are not senior managers.

These people may need to be consulted over staffing needs because:

- Enterprise policy dictates they must be consulted with on nominated issues, or on a regular basis (say, every three or six months)



- They form the nucleus of the group who provide direction for the day to day operation of the business balancing the:
 - Strategic goals and objectives of the business, and
 - Day to day imperatives of the workplace
- They usually have extensive experience in relation to staffing either at your venue, elsewhere within the industry or at other properties within the chain
- They are more readily available and accessible than the Board of Directors but usually have similar knowledge and information that the Board does.

Supervisors

Supervisors may be regarded as middle-level managers. Their next promotion will be to senior management.

Supervisors must be consulted about staffing issues in their area to:

- Enable them to provide first-hand and relevant information to you about:
 - Workplace needs
 - Service provision
 - Allied issues you may not have considered. For example, they may be able to show how reducing the hours of a certain staff member is likely to have flow-on, unseen impacts in other important areas
 - Feedback from staff about staffing action that has been proposed, or has been implemented
- Learn from their knowledge and experience relating to the staffing topic being considered. Most supervisors have an extensive working knowledge about the area for which they have responsibility
- Demonstrate your effort to work with them and include them in decision making impacting their staff. It is best to work with these people in a cooperative and collaborative manner. In many cases, if you can convince a supervisor a staffing change is a good idea, they will convince their staff likewise. Unfortunately, the reverse is also true!



Staff

Workers are often the forgotten stakeholders when staffing decisions are made.

Too many people make staffing decisions and then impose these on employees, on a 'take it or leave it' basis.

This is to be avoided.

Staff impacted by staffing decisions should be consulted to:

- Identify suggestions they have for action. Arguably staff are best placed to identify staffing issues and make recommendations for how they can best be addressed

- Provide guidance for the final decision in terms of:
 - How to effectively implement new ideas relating to staffing levels or changes to staffing
 - When to introduce changes or new ideas
 - Identification of potential problems related to change and how to overcome them
- Demonstrate respect for them as a valuable resource. Many businesses will state staff are their most important resource but do relatively little to demonstrate this
- Gain support for a staffing initiative by explaining the proposal and explaining how it benefits staff (for example, by making their work easier, safer, by saving resources, by providing increased job security, or potential for more hours/overtime or promotion.)

Customers

For some staffing considerations it can be useful to consult with stakeholders before and/or after making the necessary decisions.

This applies especially to customers.

Before making a staffing decision (such as reducing/increasing staffing levels, hiring someone in a new role, training staff in nominated new skills) it can be worthwhile talking to customers and asking them:



- What they prefer
- How the changes would impact on their relationship with the enterprise
- How the changes would impact on their spending and attendance patterns.

Always be alert to the potential customers to believe their contributions will be acted on once they have made them. Customers can become disappointed and resentful if what they told you does not materialise into reality.

In short, consulting with customers has the capacity to be counter-productive.

After staffing changes have been implemented, customers can be re-interviewed to determine:

- Levels of satisfaction
- Changes in spending as a result
- Suggestions for further staffing changes.

Suppliers

Suppliers are rarely consulted in relation to staffing needs but may be contacted in relation to:

- Identifying what is happening in other businesses. The fact suppliers deal with so many businesses similar to yours means they can provide useful insight into what others are doing and not doing

- Sourcing staff to perform designated tasks or fill nominated positions. Staff who are dissatisfied at the business where they work often tell delivery drivers and sales representatives and these people can be effective in finding suitable and experienced staff
- Providing information about what your staff (those who order stock, and deal with accounts) need to know and can do to facilitate a better relationship and smoother work flow between your business and theirs. If you demonstrate to a supplier you are trying to work with them, they will tend to work more closely with you, and go out of their way to help, find a product or make a delivery.

1.6 Describe and quantify staffing requirements by position and locate them within an organisational chart

Introduction

When determining staffing needs there is a need to base the positions identified and the number of staff required on current or projected need.

To be most effective these identified positions should be integrated into an organisational chart.

This section introduces the concept of an organisational chart and explains the benefits of using such a tool in relation to staffing activities.

What is an organisational chart?

An organisational chart is a paper-based or electronic document setting out the hierarchical relationship between all the working positions within the enterprise.

It is sometimes referred to as an 'organisation chart'.

The organisational/organisation chart identifies:

- Who is responsible to who – the 'lines of authority'
- The official lines of communication within the venue – the 'lines of communication'
- Possible career paths for people within the enterprise.
- The positions within the business – by name/title
- The numbers of positions. This is optional. Some charts identify the number of identical positions and some do not. Charts may show six separate boxes for six food waiters, or there may be one box stating 'Food waiters (6)'.

Many establishments have a 'top down' organisational chart with senior management at the top of the chart and lower-level managers, supervisors and other employees shown below them.

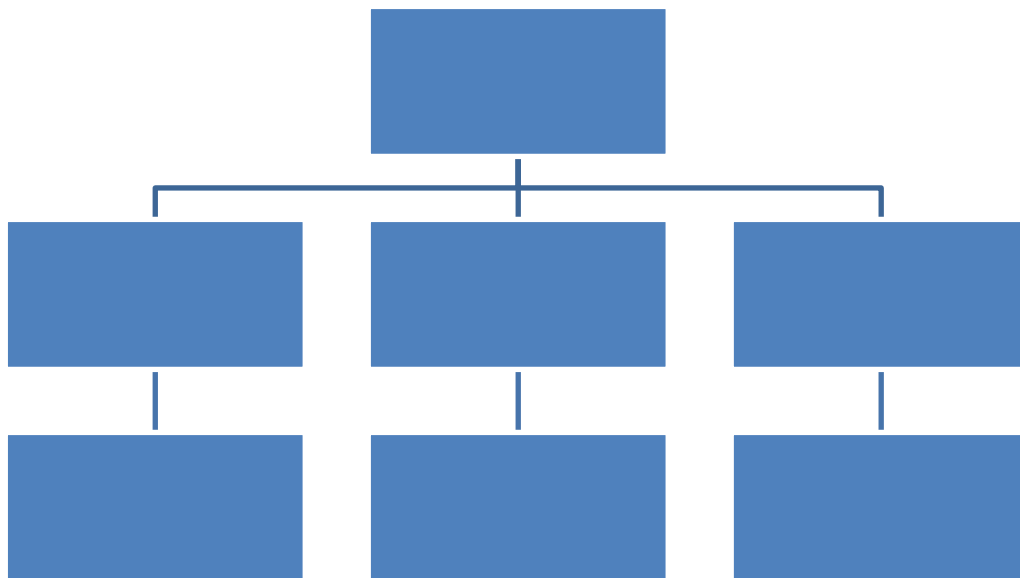
This is the traditional approach to creating organisational charts, and arguably the most common.



More modern thinking prefers the organisational chart to be a more 'equitable' in nature and features senior management on the left-hand side of the chart with lower-level managers, supervisors and other employees shown fanning out to the right-hand side. This indicates a less hierarchical approach to the business and intends to demonstrate the team-orientation to the operation of the business.

Some business prepare an inverted organisational chart with senior management at the bottom of the chart and a pyramid of lower-level managers, supervisors and other employees shown rising up from them and showing 'Customers' at the top This is intended to indicate that it is the staff who are the keys to the organisation and that management exists to support their endeavours as opposed to the traditional organisational chart which tends to indicate that staff exist to serve management.

An example of what an Organisational Chart looks like is presented below. These charts can be developed on a departmental basis, and then combined into a larger chart that reflects the entire enterprise. The blank example below shows what a traditional 'top down' Organisational Chart looks like.



Many believe the formation and structure of an organisation chart for an enterprise is a major influence on the culture of the business, and the orientation staff have to the company, their work and others within the workplace.

Using the organisational chart

The organisational chart is a management tool and it is an imperfect though useful one.

It can be imperfect because:

- Businesses often change their workforce structure but forget to update their organisational chart to reflect these changes. This means:
 - It is often out of date
 - People have little faith in something that is partially quite obviously wrong
- Workers do not like been depicted as being below management where a top-down structure is used
- The lines of communication indicated by the organisational chart are always compromised by the 'Grapevine' (see below this Section)

- The lines of authority shown on the chart are not always complied with because adhering to them would take too long to make decisions that are required immediately
- No chart can ever reflect the dynamic nature and personal working relationships that exist in any workplace. The lines shown on a chart can never illustrate the level of cooperation (or lack of cooperation) between two positions or departments.



To make use of your organisational chart you need to:

- Know who the department heads, managers and supervisors are so you know the key players to consult with and obtain advice and input from
- Know the positions and names of the staff members they have responsibility for. This way your knowledge is embedded in the reality of the workplace and does not simply exist as a disembodied and impersonal chart
- Know who they report to and who has authority over them in case you need to go above them for help or approval
- Know if the chart is current. An out-dated chart is confusing and can be worse than no chart at all
- Obtain permission to alter the organisational chart. Never make changes unless they have been approved by the owner, senior management or the Board
- Strive to balance responsibilities. Try not to over-load one person or one position with too many responsibilities or tasks. Prepare a draft first and be prepared to revise it several times if necessary.
- Revise and update the chart whenever staff changes are made in terms of:
 - Staff numbers. Where these are listed on the organisational chart it should be a standard rule staff numbers are shown somewhere on the chart
 - Names given to positions – existing positions can sometimes be re-titled
 - New positions added to the chart
 - Positions removed from the chart including those where positions may have been combined
 - Making sure new or revised charts are:
 - Included in Staff Handbooks
 - Posted in required locations throughout the business
 - Provided to management.

The grapevine

Side by side with the organisational chart (the officially approved communication structure for the business) there is a secondary communication system known as the 'grapevine':

The grapevine is the term used to refer to the informal lines of communication within a business which is an effective informal network of communication that many believe is essential for success of any organisation.

The grapevine operates side by side with the formal lines of communication and allows staff to communicate informally with each other.

It speeds up many essential communications and ensures no gaps exist in the formal structure through which excellent customer service, vital internal information, or communication may fail.

Specific job descriptions may not show anyone or any position is specifically responsible for, as an example, opening doors for customers but the grapevine will see this as necessary and ensure it gets done – all without management input.

As another example, there may be an emergency in the establishment. It would take too long for management to communicate with staff through the official lines of communication as shown on the organisational chart but the grapevine will pick up on the crisis, and deal with it instantaneously.

An effective manager accepts the presence of the grapevine and learns to use it to their advantage by tapping into it, using it and supplying it with information.

1.7 Undertake a job analysis of each identified position

Introduction

A standard requirement as part of staffing practice in every establishment should be to undertake a job analysis for every position identified on the organisational chart.

This Section identifies what a job analysis is, why they are done and how to do them.

– defined

A job analysis is the gathering all the relevant facts, details and information about a job.

It is done to:

- Identify all the tasks and duties involved in carrying out the job in question
- Determine and describe how all those tasks are linked together and executed
- Identify the precise nature of the skills, qualifications and experience needed to do the job.

The job analysis also identifies peripheral but vital issues such as:

- Authority limits of the job – scope of authority
- Operational relationships between the job and other departments/jobs
- Positional responsibilities accompanying the job.



Why undertake a job analysis?

Because the job analysis is a **very** detailed examination of the job in question with a view to identifying and uncovering every aspect about the role, the job analysis is a critical management tool in ensuring the right person is eventually selected for the job.

Two important sets of facts which come from the job analysis process is the information or details which provide the basis for the job description and the job specification (see details Section 1.8).

These are obtained by separating the job analysis information into two separate, distinct yet related areas.

The information identifying what the job is all about forms the basis of the job description.

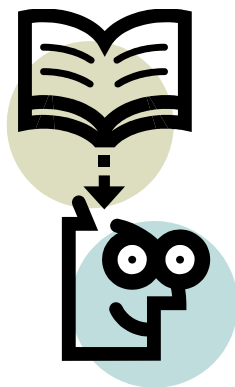
The information that identifies the best sort of person for the job forms the basis of the job specification.

The basic questions needing to be answered

The end result of a job analysis for any position should give you comprehensive and current answers to the following:

- What work does the position do? What are tasks, responsibilities and duties of the position?
- When is the work done? Or when does it need to be done?
- Where in the enterprise is the work undertaken?
- What are the range of requirements a worker needs in order to do the job as required?
- What are the working conditions relating to the position?

How is job analysis information obtained?



There are several ways to obtain the necessary detail required to produce an effective and comprehensive job analysis.

Each option is easy to apply and does not require special knowledge or skills. All that is required is a genuine desire to obtain the necessary information.

A combination of techniques always produces the best result.

Personal observation

This involves watching the job as it happens and taking notes to record the duties and tasks involved.

It sounds like a very basic thing to do, but it is surprising how revealing this exercise can be because the nature of jobs tends to change over time.

They can change so slowly you often miss the changes and suddenly things have undergone a major transformation seemingly without anyone noticing.

Encouraging feedback from staff

This requires you to talk to staff to get their inside views of the task(s) involved.

You might ask questions such as:

- How has the job changed?
- What does the job entail now?
- What tasks have to be completed?
- How is time spent in the job today compared to previously?
- What skills and knowledge are needed to do the job well?

These questions may be asked verbally or you can create a response/question sheet which the staff are asked to reply to.



Talking to supervisors and others within your management network

This entails seeking information from management level personnel about what happens in your department.

Questions should address:

- What do they need from your department in terms of service and products?
- How do they depend on your department and what it produces in order for them to be able to do their job properly?
- What needs changing in order for there to be an improvement?

Considering 'best practice'

This means investigating industry-recognised or approved steps, procedures, and protocols seen as producing the best available result in terms of, for example, productivity, safety, waste elimination, service standards, speed or cost saving.

Refer 'Benchmarking' (Section 1.4).

Consideration of what currently exists elsewhere as best practice should address:

- What should change in the workplace in terms of what is currently occurring?
- What would be involved in making these changes (cost, time, resources, training)?
- How can these changes be introduced?

Reading existing job analysis documentation

This is done to help determine how the current job or position has altered in terms of what is happening now.

The previous job analysis gives a useful reference point, or baseline on which to evaluate the changes that have taken place in terms of the requirements for each position.

Reading existing job specifications and job descriptions

These documents provide excellent detail regarding individual jobs for the purposes of comparison with what is currently happening.

See next Section for more detail on what they contain.

Two important points to bear in mind when deciding to use these as a means of undertaking a job analysis are:

- They often do not exist. Many job positions operate quite effectively within a venue without their being any formal job specification or job description for the role
- Many are out of date. It is important to check when they were produced as it is common for the position to have changed significantly without any similar change to the job documentation.

1.8 Prepare job specifications and job descriptions for identified positions

Introduction

In order to gain a definite understanding about any position in the organisation it is imperative a current job specification and a current job description are produced based on information identified in the job analysis.

This Section differentiates between the job specification and the job description and identifies the content of each.

The Job Statement

The Job Statement is a document combining the Job Description and Job Specification.

Not all enterprises have a Job Statement even though they may have both a Job Description and Job Specification.

Please note:

- The Job Description may be referred to as the 'Position Description' (or PD)
- The Job Specification is also known as the Person Specification.

When you have developed a comprehensive and accurate Job Statement you will be in a much better position to determine what type of worker to recruit because you will have a much better understanding of what the job entails and the requirements needing to be filled.

Lack of this knowledge means you may start recruiting with only a vague idea of what it is the person is required to do and this is obviously not a good idea.

Job Specifications

The job analysis will have helped to describe the type of person best suited to the job under consideration.

This addresses the *human qualities* the best person for the job would possess. This explains why some businesses refer to these as 'Person Specifications'.

The following are examples of what might be contained in a job specification:

- Title of the job – to ensure everyone can identify the job being talked about



- Minimum level of education – what level of secondary, or tertiary schooling is required, if there is such a requirement? What level of literacy and/or numeracy does the position demand?
- Any specialised education/training – is there a need for a special Certificate, or certain trade qualifications?
- Work experience – is actual, practical work experience necessary? If so, where should this experience have been gained and how much of it should there be? Should the person have had a set amount of experience in a certain business, department, trade or establishment type? Must they be familiar with certain things, certain pieces of equipment, or particular brands of machines?
- Personal attributes – is it important they have, for example, attention to detail? Must they be ‘self-starters’? Must they be able to work unsupervised? Be reliable? Be prepared to work shift work?
- Physical effort required – what degree of fitness or strength is needed? Is there heavy lifting? Will they have to spend much time on their feet?
- Interpersonal skills. Our industry relies heavily on individuals who are ‘people persons’: does this job call for a significant amount of this ability?



In other words the job specification contains all the information about the qualities required of the person who will do this job.

Job Specification – Fast Food Attendant

The shows an example of a job specification:

Position: Fast Food Attendant

Department: Food department

Outlet: Take-away restaurant

Reports to: Food and Beverage Manager

Location: Terra Magna Pool

Date: 15/11/2015

Minimum education: Must have completed High School with passes in English and Arithmetic

Vocational qualifications: Must hold approved Food Handling certificate

Previous work experience: None

Personal attributes: Must be able to:

- Work unsupervised
- Work as required including any day of the week and public holidays
- Converse in English with customers

- Demonstrate proficiency in mental arithmetic
- Provide local tourist information
- Physical effort - all working hours are spent on feet
- Interpersonal skills: Must possess:
 - Excellent communication skills
 - Excellent selling skills.

Job Descriptions

Lack of a detailed and representative job description means you have no accurate understanding of what the job is all about, and you risk selecting someone who is either unsuitable or unqualified for the position.

Where a current job description does not exist, time should be taken to create one.

Creating a job description is a process not to be rushed and they should be generated **and updated** as part standard operating procedures.

It is almost too late to prepare one of these when one is needed. It will tend to be rushed, incomplete and lacking in the essential elements underpinning its true worth.

Contents of a Job Description

A job description may contain:

- Title of the job to ensure everyone knows the exact job/position to which the description applies
- Location of the job – a description of the department where the job is located. In some properties this may also include the actual address of the job (where the establishment has multiple sites/outlets).

There may be an added indication as to whether the position is front-of-house or back-of-house

- Job responsibilities. This lists responsibilities which attach to the job within the context of your workplace, but which may not go with a similar job at another venue.

Examples may include:

- Occupational safety and health responsibilities
- Supervision of others
- Performing banking duties
- Being responsible for ordering stock
- Balancing registers at the end of trade.



- Day to day tasks/duties of the job. This is what the uninformed person might think comprises all there is to know about the job. It is a description of all work this position needs to do.

Constructing this part of the Job Description will take you a lot of time in order to determine all the work requirements. The document should accurately reflect all the tasks the employee is expected to do in the course of their work. Examples (depending on the position) may include:

- Customer service
- Selling
- Cash register operation
- Stocktaking
- Pouring draught beer
- Tapping beer kegs and managing the cellar
- Stocking shelves
- Serving food
- Mixing drinks



- Job title of the person the position reports to. This indicates who the position will be responsible to. It may be the venue manager, a department, or some other position as appropriate.

This person should have had significant input into job analysis and subsequent construction of the Job Specification and Job Description

- Number of people supervised. If the position is responsible to oversee the work of others, this section indicates the supervisory extent of the position
- Working conditions. In some job descriptions it has been found to be beneficial to note the working conditions the successful applicant is expected to work under.

It is very important to be honest in this description, as you do not want to hide from potential job applicants any working conditions that may be less than attractive. Things such as the fact the work is performed in an office, in the laundry, in a nightclub environment, may be listed. It may mention the work environment is noisy, the job is people-based, is inside or outside

- Workplace hazards. This section asks you to specify any potentially dangerous equipment, working conditions, working environment, or work practices relating to the job
- Special work procedures to be followed. This relates very much to the individual enterprise setting out unique work practices your establishment has deemed necessary but which other workplaces may not have.

This may address work practices and protocols developed by you or your employer designed to accommodate:

- Individual workplace layout
- Product standards and/or service levels
- Integration of one job or procedure with another in the workplace

- Equipment used. This varies enormously and can involve specifying a certain make/model of equipment with which the new worker will need to be familiar so as to save you (or another supervisor) having to train new employees
- Output standards required. This will not apply to all jobs, but where it does this requires you to identify what you expect of each staff member in terms of quality and quantity standards relating to their workplace performance.



This also informs potential staff members of what will be expected of them and lets them know in advance how their performance will be assessed

- Type of work measurement methods used. This may not be so much a concern of small businesses but critical where pay rises are linked to productivity, so it is clear exactly how productivity will be judged when it comes time to assess worker issues such as individual contribution to overall performance and determine associated matters such as pay rises, promotions, extra hours, further responsibilities and training.

In other words the job description contains all the information a person needs to know about the job itself.

A sample job description appears below:

Position:	Waiter/waitress
Department:	Food and Beverage department
Outlet:	Dining room
Classification:	Food and Beverage Attendant, Level 2
Reports to:	Food and Beverage Manager
Location:	Front-of-house; 3 rd Floor
Date:	24/01/2014

POSITION OVERVIEW

This position is concerned with food and beverage service to dining room guests, incorporating upselling techniques and presenting a friendly, professional presence to all guests.

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES

1. To communicate with the establishment's internal and external customers in a polite, cooperative and constructive manner
2. To perform duties in accordance with occupational safety and health requirements
3. To ensure the safety, security and cleanliness of the relevant operational area

4. To wear the supplied uniform and maintain a neat, clean and professional appearance at all times
5. To contribute suggestions to improve the operational effectiveness of the dining room
6. To actively promote all aspects of the venue to dining room guests
7. To attend food and beverage departmental meetings as requested
8. To use Squirrel system for food and beverage ordering
9. To actively participate in all required training sessions
10. To perform all work-related tasks as requested by the Food and Beverage Manager
11. To abide by all policies and procedures as laid out in the Staff Handbook

KEY TASKS

1. To greet and seat dining room patrons as directed by the Host/Hostess
2. To take food and beverage orders from guests, using upselling techniques to provide quality service and products, and to maximise revenue from each guest whilst providing a responsible, and value for money dining experience
3. To serve food and beverage items to guests in an efficient, courteous and safe manner, according to the service procedures outlined in the Food and Beverage Service Manual
4. To deliver accounts to guests and ensure correct payment is received for same
5. To anticipate and meet all legal guest needs
6. To explain and describe all menu and beverage items to guests
7. To communicate guests complaints and compliments to the appropriate person(s) including the Food and Beverage Manager
8. To clean and re-set vacated guest tables as soon as practicable in accordance with set ups as described in the Food and Beverage Service Manual
9. To ensure waiter stations remain clean and well-stocked
10. To liaise with kitchen staff, bar staff, the dining room supervisor and clearing staff as necessary
11. To farewell guests at the conclusion of their meal, and to provide whatever assistance they require on departure.

Online information

Take time to visit the following websites:

- <http://openlearn.open.ac.uk/mod/oucontent/view.php?id=397321>
- <http://www.businessballs.com/jobdescription.htm>
- http://humanresources.about.com/od/jobdescriptions/Job_Descriptions_Free_Samples_Examples.htm.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

1.1 Prepare and submit a report detailing for your workplace:

- The enterprise policies and procedures in relation to the staffing process
- Internal and external factors identified by you and/or management as impacting on staffing needs currently and in the immediate short-term, including reasons why those factors are important
- The techniques used to monitor individual staff work performance across a variety of positions
- The stakeholders who are consulted in relation to staffing needs and how their input is captured.

1.2. Identify one position in your workplace and for that position:

- Undertake and provide evidence of having conducted a job analysis for the position
 - Prepare and submit a job description for the position based on the job analysis
 - Prepare and submit a job specification for the position based on the job analysis.
-

Summary

Identify staffing needs

When identifying staffing needs:

- Obtain, read and understand all internal policies and procedures relating to staffing matters
- Realise other people – management, supervisors, existing staff and new staff – will rely on you for advice regarding staffing issues
- Obtain specific information about labour budgets, how much is available for wages and how the labour budget is calculated
- Determine if you have the ability and authority to move labour expenses between budget lines and/or from one time period to another
- Get to know the existing staff, their background and abilities, and what they are expected to do, use and/or provide
- Learn the service standards for the workplace and management and customer expectations in this regard
- Become familiar with trading hours, busy periods, volume and types of customers to be serviced at any given time
- Actively research current and projected staff movements
- Identify internal and external factors impacting on (or likely to impact on) the business
- Determine the future direction of the business and relevant changes in markets, market position, image and allied operational factors
- Factor in changes in technology and/or legislation impacting the business
- Monitor staff performance using qualitative and quantitative analysis
- Consult with management and relevant others to determine future staff needs
- Use an organisational chart to assist with staff planning and positioning of staff within the company
- Undertake job analyses as the basis for preparing current and comprehensive job descriptions and job specifications to use as the basis for recruitment and selection activities.

Element 2: Recruit staff

2.1 Identify and quantify positions to be advertised

Introduction

All staff recruitment must be targeted to identified need.

This Section focuses on the need to be certain about the positions to be filled and the number of staff required before undertaking any recruiting activities.

Types of positions

The factors to be considered when deciding what types of jobs to recruit staff for include:

- Information contained in the Job Descriptions. These are central to the decision and the primary tool to use
- Integration of the required work to be done with other positions within the business so there is, to the best extent possible:
 - Seamless joining of new staff into the existing workplace and with current staff
 - Optimisation of the use of equipment, time and other resources. The arrival of new staff should improve productivity and output rather than negatively impact on it
- Owner preference. In SMEs the business owner may have personal thoughts about staff required based on no other reason than a personal liking for a certain position
- Complaints received from customers. Where complaints have identified slow or poor service and/or products these are the areas to which attention should be focussed when hiring new staff
- Levels of business performance. Checking internal records can reveal positions where recruitment needs to occur based on indicators such as falling sales, decreasing traffic, reduced bookings
- Strategic business direction where, for example, the enterprise has decided to enter into the fine dining market and needs to recruit waiters with silver service skills, waiters with gueridon service skills, a sommelier and/or a maître d'hôtel
- New products and services, for example, providing:
 - In-room service of meals (room service) will necessitate hiring staff able to serve breakfast, lunch, dinners and suppers to guests in their room
 - Five-star service may mean the venue has to engage the services of a Concierge, porters, dining room hosts, lifeguards at the swimming pool and doormen



- Revisions to previous allocation of responsibilities and tasks. While these should be reflected in new/revised job descriptions and specifications this is not always the case.

Where a business is under new management, or decides to restructure its organisational chart there can be a need to recruit staff for certain departments who are multi-skilled to give the organisation more flexibility in terms of where it can position these workers to make the best/most cost-effective use of them.

Numbers of positions

The numbers of each identified position to be recruited must reflect:

- Advertised and expected service levels. There is a distinct relationship between staff levels/numbers and the standard of service provided to customers.

If your venue advertises high-quality or five-star service it will charge accordingly and customers expect this to be reflected in actual service delivery

- Peaks and troughs of trade. Recruitment of extra staff for high-demand times is to be expected
- Waiting times. Sufficient staff will need to be engaged to ensure the maximum acceptable waiting times for service to customers is not exceeded
- Trading times. The longer the business is open, the greater the potential for more staff
- Labour budget. The link between staffing costs and revenue must always be a major consideration.

No business or manager ever has unlimited scope to hire and pay for staff

- Statements made on the organisational chart. If the chart identifies twenty room attendants, then the maximum number who can be hired is twenty unless there is special dispensation from management to hire more
- Personal knowledge about upcoming events. This is often a blend of experience involving knowledge about other businesses in the industry and what they are doing, what happened the same time last year, local sporting/religious and other events scheduled, and customer demand on the venue at these times
- Contractual obligations. Where a business has entered into a contract with a customer (for example, for a function or an event), all promises made regarding type and numbers of staff must be met.



2.2 Develop key selection criteria for each position to be advertised

Introduction

Before interviews for positions are conducted, key selection criteria for the vacancies must be developed.

This Section addresses the role of key selection criteria and what they should address.

The role of Key Selection Criteria

Key selection criteria (KSC) are also known simply as 'selection criteria'.

During the job analysis, all the tasks involved in the position being analysed would have been identified. For every position these tasks could be classified as main and as lesser sub-tasks.

The main tasks of the job will be used to determine the key selection criteria for the job. In effect KSC are the major elements of the position.



They may include stand-alone requirements of the job or they can be a combination of necessary other requirements (from both the Job Description and the Job Specification) drawn together into a single statement, or series of points.

In addition, other important aspects of the job identified by the job analysis – but which may not be actual tasks – can also form elements of the selection criteria.

Common examples include the need for a driver's licence, a Responsible Service of Alcohol certificate, the ability to work weekends and nights.

These KSC can be seen as the non-negotiable elements of the job, the requirements which must be fulfilled by anyone obtaining the job.

When the candidates for the position are being interviewed, their applications should be judged by how well they measure up to these criteria. The better the fit between the applicant and the selection criteria, the better the chances of them getting the job.

Some employers will adopt a slightly different approach to selection criteria, calling some 'essential selection criteria' and others 'desirable selection criteria'.

Key Selection Criteria should be:

- Put in writing so there is surety and clarity about what they are for each position
- Developed in conjunction with:
 - Management and owners
 - Supervisors of the department where the employee will work and other allied supervisors
 - Staff impacted by the work the position does
- Shared with the people who will interview job applicants and make the decision about the selection of the successful job applicant for the job vacancy.

Examples of possible Key Selection Criteria

The exact nature of the KSC will vary between positions and between individual enterprises.

In general KSC will address:

- Competencies. These are the skills required to discharge the requirements of the position as identified in the job analysis
- Experience. This can be written to reflect the needs of the position in terms of, as appropriate:
 - Number of years experience in an industry, or specific industry sector. Care must be exercised to ensure this KSC does not *indirectly* breach EO requirements (for example, a KSC requiring 20 years experience automatically excludes selection of people under the age of 40 years and thus is discriminatory)
 - Time using a nominated system, item of equipment or technology
 - Context – stating, for example, that the successful candidate must have experience ‘dealing with people’, ‘selling packages to corporate clients’ or ‘supervising waiting staff’
- Qualifications – detailing the formal credentials required for the position.

These qualifications may be compliance requirements (that is, required by law), or they may be internal preferences or requirements as determined by management or owners

- Compatibility. This addresses the need for any new staff to integrate smoothly into the existing staffing arrangements and structure of the business.

The ability of new employees to ‘fit in’ and ‘get on’ with existing staff cannot be stressed too strongly.

Note: KSC are also used as the basis for preparing Interview Rating Sheets – see Section 4.1.

2.3 Obtain authority to recruit staff

Introduction

Authority to recruit staff rests with very few people in any enterprise. Sometimes only one person has the authority to permit the recruitment of staff.

This Section identifies what is involved in obtaining the necessary permission to recruit staff.

Your personal context

As you progress in the industry, you will find you have an increasing amount of discretionary authority.

This means there will be more and more things you are allowed to make decisions about without having to consult anyone else.



But, as with any job, you have to earn the confidence of management before this happens.

This applies to recruitment of staff. You will never be allowed to make any hiring decisions early in your career. You will always have to seek permission to hire (and fire) staff.

Obtaining approval

Initially you may be required to obtain approval for recruitment initiatives in accordance with enterprise policy. Later, you may be able to short-circuit this requirement, but in the beginning it is wise to 'get permission' before you start recruiting staff.

Obtaining this sort of approval can help save you from making big mistakes (due to your lack of knowledge, perhaps, or a lack of venue-specific understanding), so do not regard having to get approval as a criticism of your ability.

See it as a benefit because it enables you to talk with management and more experienced people and learn from experience, their ways of thinking and the knowledge they possess.

Approval may be:

- Verbal approval only. This is common in most enterprises. It means there is no written authorisation given
- Written approval. This would be a formal document identifying:
 - The position/s
 - Numbers of staff for whom recruitment permission is granted
 - Department the recruitment applies to
 - Remuneration for each position for which authorisation is given
 - Timelines for recruitment and selection.



To obtain approval you may need to:

- Verbally discuss the need for staff with management or a nominated person or group of people
- Make a formal presentation outlining the need for identified staff, justifying the need and defending the belief they are needed
- Demonstrate compliance with internal enterprise policies in recruitment and selection activities.

Enterprise policies

There is always a need to comply with enterprise policies in relation to recruitment.

These policies may embrace:

- Approval processes for additional recruitment. You may need to get verbal permission from certain people, or perhaps this permission needs to be in writing from head office before you engage in any recruitment activities (such as placing a job advertisement)

It is possible the need for approval for recruitment exists within your workplace but may not exist in written form. It is simply 'understood' this permission is required and everyone is expected to conform to this unwritten expectation.

- Approval processes in relation to advertised remuneration. Some businesses steer away from specifying remuneration in their advertisements so check whether or not this is the case at your workplace.

Sometimes the salary range for supervisors, managers and executives may be advertised but hourly pay rates for bar staff, waiting staff, room attendants and other operational-level staff cannot be advertised



- Required profile of potential employees. You may need to find out if management are prepared to employ trainees for a certain position or whether they want fully-trained and experienced staff.

Some businesses have a standard orientation to new staff. Some say they want *untrained* staff so they can teach them the way their organisation operates. New staff do not come with inherent bad habits or other baggage from previous employers.

Where government provides a wage subsidy (plus other benefits) for trainee positions, this can be a significant factor in determining who is targeted for a nominated position.

On the other hand, some businesses will say they only ever employ fully-trained staff because this saves them time and money on training and they are 100% work ready when they arrive.

Another variation is to aim for a blend of new/untrained staff with experienced/fully-trained staff. Some workplaces will also aim for a *gender* balance, and a balance between different *ethnic backgrounds* to maximise the languages spoken by the business

- Nature and content of job advertisements. Some premises will insist their telephone number is not included in advertisements (to prevent job applicants telephoning the business and costing valuable time).

Some businesses will insist the name of the business is not included so applicants (and other operators/competitors) do not know who is advertising for staff

- Nature and content of communications with applicants. There is often a standard protocol for those wishing to apply for a job, and this is usually spelled out in the advertisements.

Examples may include:

- 'For more information, phone the Office Manager'
- 'For a position description, phone the Personnel department on ...'
- 'Those wishing to apply should forward three hand-written copies of a current *curriculum vitae* to the Head Housekeeper before close of business on Friday, 4th July'.

- Use of different media in the recruitment process. Establishments traditionally use the printed media (predominantly newspapers) whilst other businesses use a range of options.

See next Section 'Identify sources of staff' for more detail on options

- Promoting internally. Business may have a policy of recruiting for higher-level positions from within the company before any external advertisements or searches are undertaken.

This policy can act as a motivator for existing staff and demonstrate there is a career path available in the organisation for employees who want to progress

- Converting casual staff to part-time, and/or converting part-time to full-time as opposed to hiring new staff.

Again, this policy provides existing staff with job security and demonstrates to workers that management values them and are prepared to reward them for good work

- Participants in interview panels. Not all interviews are conducted using a *panel* format. Many industry interviews are one on one interviews between the department supervisor and the individual job applicant.

Where interview panels are used it is common for the supervising manager to be on the panel together with at least one other staff member from the area under consideration.

When panels are used, panels of two to three people are normal

- Timing and nature of induction programs. These must be conducted early on, and will vary from a quick tour around the department, to a fuller, one to two day affair covering the entire premises.

See Element 5 for more information

- Role of different personnel within the recruitment, selection and induction process. These responsibilities may be shared within the one establishment, or may be focused within the one individual or concentrated within one department.



2.4 Identify sources of staff

Introduction

New staff may be recruited from a variety of sources.

This Section identifies the potential staff sources and presents issues for consideration when deciding where to source new workers.

The context

The preferred sources of staff – that is, the preferred way for your employer to advertise job vacancies – will have come about as a result of a combination of factors:

- Experience with what is effective and what is not.

Every business has experience with what options have worked for them in the past, and what options have failed.

Businesses tend to re-use options that have worked in the past, and resulted in the hiring of good staff, quickly, at an acceptable time and with minimum effort.

This highlights that many businesses tend to not pay sufficient attention to a critical aspect of staffing – the recruitment process

- Cost – employers will seek to minimise the cost of recruiting staff
- Time – most businesses will prefer to spend less time on staff recruitment than more time.

When you start recruiting staff, you will be expected to conform with standard workplace practice in this regard.

The time to introduce new practices, recruitment options and staffing protocols is **after** you have gained workplace experience and credibility.

Media advertisements

The most common media for placement of job vacancy advertisements are newspapers.

These are usually local mainstream newspapers but can include international newspapers and smaller circulation local community newspapers.

Some premises will use a very brief two to five lines in the 'Situations Vacant' section of the local (regional and/or national) newspaper/s whilst others will place large, display advertisements prominently featuring the name and logo of the property.

The more prestigious the advertisement, the larger the property tends to be.

Care and attention should be taken with the construction and wording of job vacancy advertisements as they should assist in the screening process of applicants. For example, if a position necessitates night work this should be spelled out in the advertisement. If applicants must be able to speak English, this too should be mentioned.



In rare instances a business may elect to use radio and/or television to recruit staff but these options are relatively expensive and tend only to be used when other avenues for recruiting staff have failed and/or there is an urgent need for employees.

Businesses can also elect to advertise job vacancies in trade magazines.

Job agencies and recruitment agencies

These are businesses specialising in the recruitment of staff for businesses.

They can be government-funded organisations or private enterprise operations.

Most establishments will use the services of only one employment agency and this is usually an agency they have worked with before and has demonstrated they can source and refer only worthwhile candidates for the positions available.

Most agencies will strive to develop an ongoing relationship with any business using their services and are eager to identify and meet your specific needs. This means you have to know what your needs are.

When dealing with these agencies they recruit and screen potential staff on your behalf, evaluating them against the criteria you provide to them. They then 'refer' (or 'forward') to you only those applicants they believe meet your requirements and are worthy of an interview.

The final decision about whether or not to hire staff who are referred to you, of course, rests with you. You are not obliged to employ anyone who is referred to you.

Check out http://www.jobcyclone.com/business_directory.php as a starting point for employment agencies that may be of use to you, or do a search on the web or in the telephone book for 'employment agencies' or 'recruitment agencies'.

Some agencies will require you to sign and commit to a contract before using their services, and some will not.

Some government services may be free but commercial organisations will charge for their services.

Some agencies are industry-specific and others are general.

Internet recruitment

There has been an explosion in the use of the internet to recruit staff.

Businesses often include a 'Work with Us' section on their website, advertising vacancies available and explaining how to apply.

See http://www.panpacific.com/en/singapore/offers/index.html?override_form=38 .

Alternatively there are several recognised and effective businesses operating on the internet. All require employers to register (and pay a fee) before lodging vacancies.

Check the following:

- <http://www.asianjobsite.co.uk/>
- <http://www.orientpacific.com/goldrec.htm>



- <http://www.escapeartist.com/jobs31/japan.htm>
- <http://skorcareer.com.my/blog/15-popular-job-and-recruitment-websites-in-malaysia/2008/01/15/> .

Internal advertising

Every business should be alert to the potential for recruiting employees from within their own organisation.

There are many benefits associated with recruiting someone to a position who already knows about the company and how it operates, is familiar with its terminology and practices and knows other staff, management and customers.

In practice, internal advertising/recruitment may include:

- Speaking to individuals you know are interested or who have mentioned a desire to extend themselves, or change roles
- Posting an advertisement in the staff room
- Mentioning the vacancy at staff meetings and briefings
- Enclosing a copy of the job advertisement in pay envelopes.



Schools and trade colleges

Many excellent staff can be sourced from training institutions specialising in your particular industry, or labour division.

Contacting staff at the school and advising them of your needs can result in the school referring an excellent worker who has already demonstrated an interest in the industry and who will already have some necessary skills.

Forming this type of working relationship can be mutually beneficial and is something many businesses strive to do in order to:

- Help train the next generation of workers
- Guarantee an ongoing supply of trained staff
- Give something back to their country and industry.

Industry network contacts

This involves using your personal industry network to help identify potential applicants.

As you build experience in the industry you will develop contacts who can assist you in identifying individuals who are looking for work.

Never be shy about contacting these people and advising them of your needs.

Note, however, the industry frowns on one business 'poaching' staff from another business.

Other staff

This is allied to 'internal advertising' but different.

It means:

- Talking to in-house trainers and asking them to identify staff with the potential to undertake work for positions where vacancies exist
- Talking to other supervisors to see if they have staff who may be suitable and looking for a change in position
- Observing staff to identify possible applicants based on their workplace performance
- Analysing workplace performance assessments. Where formal staff assessments are conducted in the workplace, the documentation associated with these can indicate potential applicants.

Considering people who have already registered with you

Many enterprises encourage people who are looking for work to complete a standard application form for work even where no identified vacancy exists.

These forms are then kept on file and referred to as a staffing source when workers are required.

Some businesses also retain applications of those who applied for vacancies in the past but were unsuccessful in gaining a job.

Participating in career fairs

Some businesses participate in regular trade or career fairs as a means of recruiting staff.

These fairs are commonly aimed at school leavers but also attract interest from the general public, both those who are unemployed and those seeking a career change.



Much planning is required for these to be successfully used as a recruitment tool. There is, of course, a significant expense incurred for participation. Stands have to be manned, advertising (including the event packages – see next Section) have to be prepared and the overall image of the establishment has to be maintained.

Use of career fairs as a recruitment tool is ineffective as a *short-term* recruitment solution because most of these events have quite long lead-times (up to six months). However they can be very useful as part of an overall recruitment strategy aimed at actively seeking out job applicants and keeping the name of the establishment in the minds of job seekers.

Your organisation can also be represented by a recruitment agency at these career fairs. For a fee they will promote your establishment as an employer and answer questions and register applicants on your behalf.

Careers fairs can be industry-specific or generic, and frequently feature employment agencies, schools and various government bodies. They usually feature career advice, tips on how to apply for jobs, writing applications and CVs, interview techniques and how to gain work experience.

Online 'career fairs' have also become popular. Check out <http://www.careersfair.com/> as an example of what is available and what is offered.

2.5 Develop and lodge job advertisements/notices with identified sources of staff

Introduction

Effective recruitment of staff through the media and recruitment agencies is based on the provision of suitable advertisements or information to them.

This Section identifies issues to consider and information to provide.

Context

Most establishments will have a definite 'image' they have developed over time, and which they actively promote in the advertisements they present in the marketplace and the media.

This image creates expectations in the minds of customers and it is important your sourcing of staff reflects this image.

This may mean certain people who may have the skill sets matching the requirements of the job will need to be ignored if management believes their appearance or attitude does not reflect the image of the organisation.

Producing media advertisements

When a decision has been made to engage new or additional staff, and the appropriate job description, job specification and selection criteria have been prepared, the next step may be to create media advertisements for the position.

It may be a requirement within your workplace to have these approved before final public release.

Approval may need to be gained from the Personnel department, the manager, owner or head office.

Once the advertisement has been approved it will need to be disseminated. This means distributing, or releasing it to your chosen advertising media, or employment agencies.

Points to consider when writing a job advertisement include:

- Business name and contact details. Check with the business first however because some establishments prefer not to advertise their name as it can cause too many calls to be made to the premises.

You may want to include the address and telephone number, or there may be a requirement not to do so



- Job title and job description providing a brief outline of the tasks required to be carried out.

This may need to be highlighted (that is, put in bold or large print) as it is often the element of the advertisement that attracts the attention of potential applicants

- Description of the ideal applicant. This must be based on the job description and detail experience, skills, personal qualities and qualifications.

It is important this is an accurate and honest depiction of who or what is required as it enables the advertisement itself to screen out inappropriate applicants

- The basis on which the person will be employed – permanent or casual, full-time or part-time.

If there are a set number of hours per week this should be included.

If there is the potential for overtime it is good to include this too

- Benefits of the job. This will depend sometimes on the position being advertised. Some establishments only include this sort of information for management level jobs.

Information that might be included may relate to pay rates, flexible hours, free parking, employee discounts

- Indication of how to apply. As and where appropriate give contact details including name of person to contact, a telephone number, fax number, email address and/or postal (as opposed to 'street') address.

Indicate whether or not you want the applicant to telephone or write for an application form.

Tell applicants if the selection criteria are available to them and indicate if you want hand-written or typed applications.

Some organisations also offer tips on applying for positions with the company

- Closing date for applications.

Tips on creating job vacancy advertisements

The following will help produce an effective job vacancy advertisement:

- Write clearly – avoid jargon and enterprise-specific terminology
- Write a draft and be prepared to revise and revise it
- Refer to previous similar advertisements and use them as a basis
- Include relevant information from the most recent job analysis to help identify what the job involves and to help screen out unsuitable applicants
- Name a contact person so applicants can ask questions and/or obtain further information



- Read what you have written from the perspective of an applicant. Try to see the advertisement through their eyes. Consider asking someone else to read the draft advertisement and provide you with feedback
- Do not waffle – stick to the necessary points. Do not load the advertisement with irrelevancies
- Consider alternative ways for applicants to respond. You may be able to offer the following application options to job seekers:
 - Paper-based application form. This is useful where it is important for applicants to have good hand-writing
 - Online application form at company website
 - Hand-deliver application
 - Post applications to designated address, agency or box number
 - Fax application through to given number or agency
- Sell the benefits of the job. Highlight (as appropriate and as allowed) things such as pay and conditions
- Point to additional information available. Tell people where they can go and/or what they should do to obtain (where available) KSC, tips on applying, website for the organisation.



Other considerations

Where possible refer to previous job advertisements the establishment has used and use these as the basis for your first few job vacancy advertisements.

If no samples of previous advertisements exist, take a look through the newspapers at what other establishments have done to pick up some tips on what you might write.

It is also important to check with the source you intend using (that is, for example, the newspaper with which you intend placing the advertisements) to identify any special requirements they may have. Common requirements can relate to size, terminology allowed, time by which advertisements have to be lodged, quality of the finished product, use of company logos.

You must also check with management to determine how much money is available for the placement of advertisements.

This can dictate the medium to be used, the placement of the advertisement in that medium, how many times it runs and the size of the advertisements.

It is always worthwhile getting someone else to proof-read any job vacancy advertisement you create as a way of ensuring its accuracy and identifying whether or not any important information has been omitted.

Making application form available

Where your establishment has a standard job application form this must be made available to all applicants as a way of standardising their application, and as a means of creating the file that will constitute their formal application for employment.

If your establishment does not have such a form, you will need to develop one. These forms should be made freely available and are commonly available at the reception desk, via phone or fax, or on the Internet.

Visit <http://www.vibehotels.com.au/default.asp?page=/about-vibe/careers-at-vibe-hotels/employment-application-form> to view an example of an online application form relevant to the hospitality industry.

Providing information recruitment agencies

Because recruitment agencies will be screening applicants on your behalf, they must be provided with all the work-related information necessary for them to conduct a job interview.

Commonly, recruitment agencies will:

- Meet with you face to face or by telephone to determine your specific requirements for the vacancy. This includes capturing all relevant information relating to the position (as identified under 'Producing media advertisements', above)
- Advertise the position on their own system, in their offices, via the media or through other agencies and technologies they have at their disposal
- Capture registrations of interest from applicants
- Conduct a desktop analysis of applicants to determine the extent to which they meet your requirements, and to determine if the applicant will move to the next stage
- Conduct an interview with applicants who have met the basic requirements for the job and appear suitable for the position based on information provided to them by you
- Refer applicants who 'pass' the face to face interview for your consideration.



It is important to provide recruitment agencies with all available information about the job vacancy because they can only be effective if they have all the relevant information.

Recruitment agencies will not reveal the name of the business they are recruiting for in order to prevent applicants calling directly on you, and to protect their commission/fee when they refer a person who converts to a paid staff member.

Preparing event package for applicant

An event package is more commonly known as an 'information package'.

Where this package is used as part of a career fair it can be referred to as an 'event package'.

The package can contain a variety of information but is essentially aimed at providing background and supplementary information of a generic nature about the organisation.

It is commonly used by larger businesses.

The information contained can include:

- Details about the history of the business – where and when it started, who started it

- Statistics outlining size and scope of the business, number of people served, number of staff employed, turnover
- Awards – detailing any industry awards or prizes the business has one over the years
- Rates – sample menus, wine lists, room rates, schedules, time tables
- Locations of the business – detailing where the organisation has properties, outlets, offices or agencies
- Career paths – outlining the positions available for employees within the business
- Policies – containing essentials of the specific employment-related company policies
- Photographs – showing the facilities and thereby indicating the expected dress and personal presentation standards required from applicants.

Compliance with relevant legislation

It is necessary for you to identify and become familiar with the specific legal obligations imposed on employment advertisers by your relevant national agency.

In general terms, job vacancy advertisements should ensure they:



- Make it clear all people with the right skills, qualifications and experience will be considered for the position thereby indicating compliance with EO requirements
- Mention any flexible working arrangements in place or that will be considered for the right person to highlight preparedness to hire mature age people, working parents and care-givers
- Avoid words such as 'young' and 'mature' as well as specifying age ranges or limits are unlawful so the wording of the advertisement is age-neutral. If you are looking for mature age workers, consider replacing the terms 'senior' or 'mature person' with 'experienced', or 'able to work unsupervised'
- Avoid any reference to race, religion, marital/parental status or other personal characteristics. Focus the advertisement on the specific skills and qualifications required
- Include a statement such as 'we are an age-friendly organisation' or 'people of all ages are encouraged to apply' to demonstrate there is no age-based discrimination
- Contain gender-neutral terminology. For example use 'Supervisor' instead of 'Foreman', use 'Room Attendant' instead of 'House Maid' and use 'Waiting staff' instead 'Waitresses'.

Some job vacancy advertisements contain a statement at the bottom of the advertisement to the effect 'We are an Equal Opportunity Employer – for details of our EO policy please visit www.nameofthewebsiteforthecompany

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 Identify one position in your workplace and:

- Develop key selection criteria for the position
- Describe the internal authority required before a job vacancy advertisements can be lodged
- Identify the sources of staff you may consider when recruiting applicants for this position
- Prepare one or more job vacancy advertisements suitable for:
 - Lodging in the local newspaper/s
 - Loading onto your workplace website
 - Placement with a recruitment agency.

Summary

Recruit staff

When recruiting staff:

- Be certain about vacancies for positions and staff numbers
- Prepare Key Selection Criteria for each vacancy based on analysis and individual workplace requirements
- Ensure appropriate authority is obtained to advertise vacancies, recruit applicants and engage new staff
- Comply with house policies and established practice when advertising for staff
- Consider multiple advertising/recruitment options – media, online, recruitment agencies, internal sourcing, contacting trade schools, participating in trade fairs
- Use personal contacts and industry networks
- Review previous job applicants to determine if there are any suitable applicants
- Develop suitable advertisements that will provide sufficient information about the job to help inform applicants but also cull inappropriate and/or unsuitable applications
- Provide necessary job vacancy information to assist recruitment agencies work effectively for you
- Only make public information authorised by management/owners. Check with individual workplaces to identify what can and cannot be released
- Ensure all relevant employment-related legislation is complied with when advertising for staff.

Element 3: Interview staff

3.1 Accept job applications

Introduction

When advertisements for positions have been lodged there will be a need to accept applications for those vacancies.

This section examines the issues involved in accepting job applications.

General background

After advertisements have been lodged with the media, and after your vacancies have been listed with recruitment agencies, you can expect applications to begin to arrive.

You can also expect a regular stream of telephone calls and queries in relation to the position being advertised. You should expect these even where advertisements have not given the name of your business or provided a contact telephone number. Many job applicants can work out where a job vacancy is located by 'reading between the lines' of the advertisement.

There may be calls from potential applicants seeking more information, and/or queries from recruitment agencies wanting clarification of issues raised by applicants.

After responding to these questions, the primary aim of this stage in the recruitment process is to accept all incoming applications.

Taking applications

Despite clear and obvious instructions about applications – for example, that they must be mailed in – there are often excellent applications which arrive by other means. For example, they may be e-mailed, faxed through, or hand-delivered.



Many applicants will hand-deliver their application where they believe their actual personal appearance may positively influence a hiring decision.

Sometimes, all applications not complying with stated application requirements to the letter are rejected out of hand. This is an understandable approach ("Can't they even follow simple instructions?"), but it may mean very good people are overlooked.

It is a good practice for all applications to go to a central point for ease of administration and in order to facilitate the keeping of records about who, and how many, have applied.

A simple register of applicants can record who has applied, how they applied, and when they applied. This register need only be a standard exercise book appropriately ruled up with suitable headings, or an electronic document.

When the closing date arrives, all the applicants can then be processed. Note that in many establishments, the applications are assessed more or less as they arrive.

This initial processing simply means assessing every application to ascertain whether or not the person actually matches the selection criteria. It is not unknown for people with little or no alignment with stated experience or qualifications to nonetheless apply. If they do measure up, their application passes to the next stage.

If their application does not meet the basic requirements, it is rejected at this stage and a letter of 'Thanks and Regret' is sent to the applicant. The sooner this is done, the better.

A letter of 'Thanks and Regret' thanks the applicant for applying but regrets in this instance that their application is unsuccessful.

Sending these letters to unsuccessful applicants is sound business practice and also assists in PR for the venue.

Some businesses will also send back the actual application, including resumé.

Some businesses will retain the application and keep it on file for future reference where the applicant is deemed to be suitable.

Applications kept on file can be useful in situations where:

- The person selected for the position does not accept the offer
- Extra staff for the same position (or similar) are required.

3.2 Short-list applicants

Introduction

Short-listing applicants is the process of developing a list of applicants who will proceed through to the interview stage of the selection process.

This Section presents issues to be addressed at this stage of the process.

Short-listing activities

Short-listing is deciding which applicants to interview, and which ones not to.

Applicants may pass an initial screening but still not make it to the short-list.

Practices for deciding who should be short-listed may include (depending on the position involved):

- A brief reading of the Covering Letter sent in by the applicant to gauge their suitability and gain an overview of their experience
- A brief reading of their CV to determine the extent to which their experience, qualifications and other relevant factors meet (or fail to meet) the key selection criteria for the position
- A brief reading of the business 'Application form' where such a document is required to be completed by applicants
- A brief perusal of accompanying documentation such as references and copies of certificates



When a decision about shortlisting is made there will be a need for:

- Updating the register applicants, where applicable, to reflect applicants who have been rejected at this stage
- Filing suitable applications for later use in the interview process.

In reality, the more senior the position, the more extensive the shortlisting activities are likely to be.

Possible additional activities

Generally speaking the shortlisting process involves a simple decision as to whether the applicant will be shortlisted or not but sometimes there may be a need to:

- Contact a potentially useful applicant to seek more information
- Contact the applicant to clarify something in their application
- Contact the recruitment agency to obtain more information and to capture their impression about the applicant.



After short-listing

Those who are shortlisted:

- Will need to be advised of this so a date and time for interview can be arranged (see Section 3.4)
- May have their references checked *before* a final decision to interview them is made. This will depend on house policy. It is not common to check references and referees before interview as this can be very time-consuming.

Applicants who are not shortlisted

Applicants who are not shortlisted are, most of the time, those who are rejected and will not be interviewed.

Their application should be processed as soon as possible and this may include:

- Sending them a letter of 'Thanks and Regret'
- Returning their CV and other materials sent as part of their application. Note that many young applicants often send 'original' copies of school certificates, birth certificates and trade qualification so they will be pleased to have these returned to them.



Keeping applications on file

It is **unusual** for those who are not shortlisted to have their application kept on file but this may happen:

- Where another position that may be suitable for an applicant is known to be coming up.

For example, an applicant for a beverage waiting position may have applied and their CV shows no actual drink waiting experience but extensive bar experience in terms of mixing drinks. If you knew a vacancy for a bar attendant was coming up next week you may hold on to this application and contact the person to see if they were interested in the bar job

- An applicant has a skill or experience the property is searching for to use in a different area. For example, an applicant who has very good English-speaking skills may be suitable for employment in a different area, and be able to be retrained with relative ease into the other requirements of the position.

The important point to bear in mind is to scan every application with a view to considering if applicants are suitable for another job position within the business.

3.3 Check references and referees

Introduction

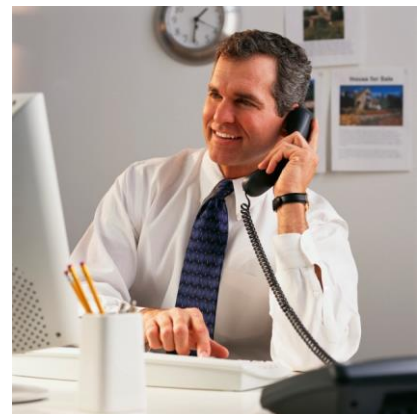
A standard aspect of the job selection process is the need to check references and referees provided by applicants

This Section identifies key points in this stage of selection.

References and referees

Some businesses will ask applicants to include references and/or referees with their application. Some will not.

It is standard practice for most applicants to include references and referees where there is no direction not to do so.



References

References are written testimonials about the applicant provided by those who know the applicant (such as past employers, previous co-workers, or important people in the community, for example, community leaders, religious people, club officials].

References are usually type-written and presented on letterhead paper as a way of proving they are written by the person providing the reference.

References usually contain details and information about:

- Date when reference was written
- Name and position of the person writing the reference
- How long the person has known the applicant

- Their character and reliability. Statements are made about their hard-working nature, how well they performed in their job, and how sorry the previous employer was to see them leave.

These comments may be work-related or social (remember those applying for their first job will not be able to provide work references because they have not held a job before).

Statements of Employment

Note some businesses refuse to provide 'references' to employees as a SOP.

Such businesses will only provide a 'Statement of Employment'.

A Statement of Employment is a *pro forma* document giving only basic information about the employee and providing no individual or personal information at all. The Statement of Employment will simply tell you:

- Employee name
- Employer name
- Position/s held by the employee
- Time period employed in each position.

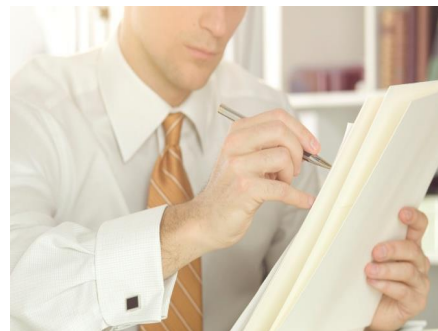
Referees

Referees may be seen as:

- Anyone who has provided a written reference
- A person who has not written a reference but is prepared to speak to a prospective employer about the applicant.

Many people will not provide a written reference but are happy to be referees because:

- They do not know how to write a reference and/or do not know what to put into one
- They are too busy to do so
- They have nothing positive to say about the person who has asked for a reference.



Checking references and referees

Checking references (or referees) means contacting the people who have been listed on the resumé as referees and/or those who have provided a written reference.

As mentioned, sometimes these are checked:

- Before interview as part of the short-listing process to determine whether or not some applicants are worthy of an interview or not
- After the interview to help determine the selected applicant from all those deemed suitable. Doing checks at this point reduces the number of checks that have to be made and the time taken in reference/referee checking.

Why bother?

It is important to check references and referees because:

- Modern technology has made it easy for computer literate applicants to generate false reference documentation. You need to be able to:
 - Verify the applicant has worked for the person/organisation stated
 - Validate they have performed the roles/functions they have claimed
 - Validate claims made about their ability and/or experience
- No-one has ever written a bad reference. All references seem to speak in glowing terms about the applicant. As the old saying states 'No-one has read a bad reference'
- This check enables you to speak person-to-person with the individual who wrote the reference and they are often more honest and forthcoming when questioned directly about the person in question
- You need to be able to verify with the referee:
 - Statements made in written references
 - Claims made by the applicant.

Note:

1. Not all employers will check references and/or referees
2. Some businesses will only check written references. That is, they will contact the person who wrote the reference if possible
3. Some businesses will check both written references and those people included as 'verbal' referees
4. All applications should have either references or referees checked. Checking both is preferable but not always possible. For example, a referee may be overseas, they may have left the job where they wrote the reference or they may have passed away.

Asking questions

When checking references and referees:

- Telephone contact is the most useful and effective method to use
- Identify yourself by name, position and explain why you are contacting them. It is standard practice for applicants to advise referees they have used them for a job application, so they should be expecting your call
- Enquire if they are prepared to answer some questions about the applicant
- Thank them for their time.



Questions

It is common for referees to be asked questions such as:

- What was the applicant's work ethic like?
- Were they punctual, reliable, honest?

- Did they get on well with other staff?
- Did they get on well with customers?
- Why did they leave?
- Were you sorry to see them go?
- Would you employ them again?

Standard practice is to:

- Generate questions to reflect what needs to be clarified, verified or validated about the applicant
- Write these questions down with room to record answers. Never rely just on memory to remember what needs to be asked. These questions and the answers received can form part of the selection documentation and be useful in demonstrating why one person was chosen over another
- Record the responses given by referees when asked the questions.



Be prepared to answer questions yourself

It must be part of your standard procedure to be ready to answer questions from other employers about your previous staff.

When another business contacts you for information about one of your employees who is applying for a job, be honest. If the employee is not worth employing, you must make that clear. If the employee was a great employee who you did not want to lose, this too must be stated.

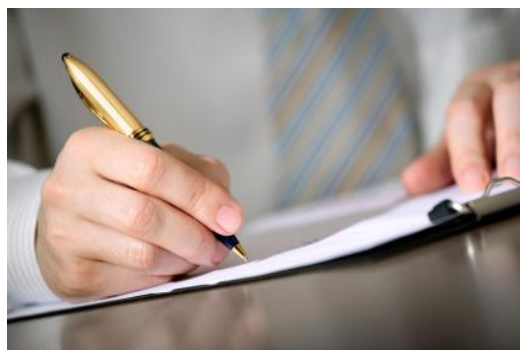
Being honest with other employers encourages them to be honest with you so it is a mutually beneficial thing to do.

Use of photographs

Asking applicants to provide photographs could constitute a request for discriminatory information.

It can be argued that a photograph provides the person making the decision with information (about race, age and physical features) which has no bearing on an applicant's ability to perform a job.

As a rule, an establishment should not ask applicants to send photographs with their applications.



3.4 Notify applicant of interview

Introduction

Applicants shortlisted for a position will need to be contacted so a date and time for interview can be arranged.

This Section examines the factors to consider when performing this task.

Background

Where a decision has been made to proceed with certain applications, it is important to inform applicants about this as soon as possible.

You want to keep the applicant interested in the job, and you must realise the one applicant has probably applied for more than one job. Whilst they may want your job, they may also take another job offered to them before you have a chance to interview them.

Some businesses:

- Notify shortlisted applicants as soon as they are identified as being eligible for interview
- Wait until the advertised closing date for applications before shortlisting and notifying successful applicants.

Most businesses will interview applicants referred by a recruitment agency as soon as possible.

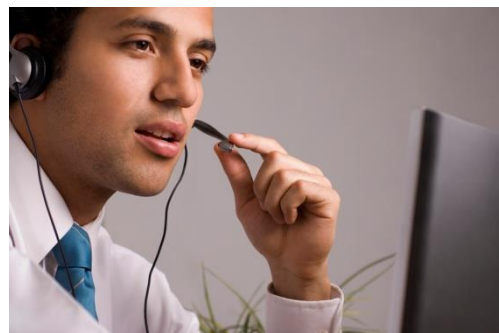
Notifying applicants

Usually notification takes place by telephone but e-mail, fax and face to face are all acceptable alternatives.

This communication should be quite clear and inform the applicants about the next step which is normally a formal interview, so the notification should specify:

- Date and time of the interview
- Location – where the interview will take place. This may include a street address, a floor number and/or even a specific room name within the business
- What they should bring. This may be originals of certificates and/or examples of work
- Expected length of the interview – start and finish time
- Format of the interview – is it a one to one interview? If it is a panel interview, you may supply the number on the panel, their names and/or their position within the organisation.

Note there is nearly always a need to accommodate the needs and preferences of those to be interviewed when scheduling interview dates and times. This means notifying applicants about their interview is never a matter of telling them a time and date on a ‘take it or leave it’ basis’.



Many applicants have to fit the interview in around existing work commitments, family obligations and, sometimes, their social life.

Some interviews may be conducted by telephone especially where the applicant lives a long way away or in another country.

In some cases, the questions to be asked at the interview will be sent out to the applicants in advance so they can prepare their responses.

Alternatively many interviewers prefer to keep the interview questions secret and judge the candidate's reaction 'on-the-spot', evaluating their ability to 'think on their feet', and believing these immediate responses are most likely to provide a better insight into the applicant.

Some venues may even provide a list of 'Interview tips for applicants' which may include advice on handling interviews, and suggestions on how to approach the interview situation.

It is standard operating procedure for some organisations to send out information about the business to those who are going to be interviewed.

This can be a standard 'information package' outlining the organisation's history, stating its primary goals, and explaining venue policies and procedures.

This is done to provide potential staff with more detailed insight into the business and its ethics thereby allowing the potential staff member to make a more informed choice about whether or not they want to work for the company.

3.5 Conduct job interview

Introduction

The most high profile aspect of the recruitment and selection process is the job interview.

This Section identifies activities needing to be undertaken prior to the interview and during the interview, and presents a range of different interview options.

This Section should be read in conjunction with Section 4.1.

Internal arrangements

In addition to the notifications given to interview candidates, arrangements will have to be made internally for most interviews, especially where there are several people to interview.

In all cases organisational policies will need to be observed and there is an obligation to cater for special needs as they apply (see below).

Interview arrangements may include:

- Booking a room for the interviews such as the Board room, an office or a section of an unused dining room or bar closed to the public and free of wandering staff
- Determining the time to be allowed for each interview and allowing for breaks to be scheduled between each interview so interviews can be reviewed and evaluated and interviewers can discuss the candidate for the job
- Scheduling the actual interviews with shortlisted applicants

- Identifying who will participate in the interviews. It is common practice to ensure a gender balance on all interview panels wherever possible
- Pre-reading and digesting all appropriate resumés to be sure interviewers are familiar with the applicant and their background
- Facilitating a meeting between all members of the interview panel or group to:
 - Identify the specific format of the interview – see immediately below
 - Identify the questions to be asked
 - Clarify the relevant job description, job specification and selection criteria
 - Identify who will lead the interview, welcome the applicant, and terminate the interview
 - Identify who will ask which questions, and in which order
- Arranging catering (such as coffee, tea and/or iced water), where required.

Format of the interview

The basic job interview options are:

- One on one interviews. This is common where the position is for a lower level position and where the person conducting the interview (often the owner, manager or supervisor) believes they are best placed to determine the best applicant.

This interview involves the applicant sitting face to face with the interviewer and responding to their questions.

This style of interview is quick, requires only one person to be involved but suffers potentially from lack of objectivity. It is very common in smaller, owner-operated businesses

- The panel interview where a number of people (three to five is common) interview one applicant at a time
- The group interview where a number of applicants are interviewed simultaneously by a range of interviewers.

Note: some people refer to a 'panel' interview as a 'group' interview so be sure to determine what term is used in your workplace to avoid confusion

- Telephone interview where one or more people use a teleconference (of some format – for example, Skype or Lync) to interview applicants.

Telephone interviews are difficult (and arguably of minimum use) for both interviewers and interviewees as both are commonly not familiar with either conducting them or participating in them.

Rounds of interviews

In much the same way applicants are shortlisted for interview, an interview may be also used to determine if an applicant moves to the next 'round of interviews'.

This is not especially common but the practice of 'interview rounds' does exist with it being most used for middle to higher level positions.

The first interview (the first 'round of interviews') will involve all those who were shortlisted. The interview enables interviewers to meet the applicants, ask some questions and form an opinion. Applicants are usually asked the same questions and

evaluated against the same criteria. The focus of the first round questions is 'can this person do the job?'

Traditionally, a number of applicants are rejected by the interviewers after this first interview for a variety of reasons.

Those remaining may be asked to undertake a designated test or other task and their performance may or may not determine if they are asked to attend a second interview (the 'second round of interviews').

The second round of interviews focuses more on the individual applicants (as opposed to the job they are being expected to do) and questions tend to address their individual ability, history, suitability, attitude, knowledge, and expertise. The focus of this round therefore tends to be 'why should I employ you for this job?'

At the end of this second round, more applicants are commonly rejected (but not necessarily so).

The third round is the final interview where 'more difficult' issues and questions are covered. It is the outcome of this 'interview round' which determines the successful candidate for the job.

Other processes

In addition to formal interviews, establishments may elect to also include some method of practical evaluation as part of the selection process (see Section 3.6).

This practical component can range from the simple (pouring a draught beer, making a bed, carrying and clearing plates), to the complex (preparing a meal, trouble-shooting a problem in the cellar or coolroom, analysing a set of statistics, responding to a case study).

Where these 'other processes' are to be implemented as part of the interview process the necessary time, space and resources also have to be arranged to enable this.

In addition, you will need to prepare some sort of assessment matrix to enable objective interpretation of each individual performance.

Catering for Special needs applicants

For a business to be genuinely non-discriminatory, its interview and selection processes must reflect this orientation.

It is difficult for an organisation to claim it is 'an Equal Opportunity employer' when its selection processes fail to cater for special needs.

The individual applications should identify the need for addressing these areas but possible responses to special needs can include:

- Scheduling the interview at an appropriate time for the candidate to accommodate their transport and other needs
- Providing certain documentation in large print
- Providing easy access and/or car parking to facilitate attendance at the interview
- Determining if there is a need for technology to assist and taking steps to provide it where necessary
- Preparing yourself to be sensitive to individual needs at the interview such as training yourself to look directly at a person who lip reads

- Preparing and using visual materials and diagrams in cases where written material is inappropriate
- Using an interpreter, as appropriate – including sign language
- Allowing support persons to accompany the person being interviewed
- Including a 'special needs' person as part of the interview panel.

Interview skills

Whether the selection interview is one on one or a panel type it should be structured and have a focus. It must not simply be a 'get-together' for a pleasant chat where anything and everything is discussed.

The time spent in conducting interviews is another of the considerable expenses associated with staff hiring, and the time should be spent wisely.

Those involved should also realise interviewing is a difficult task and give it the proper attention it deserves and prepare adequately for it. You can never just walk into an interview situation 'cold' and expect to be effective.

You must prepare and get yourself organised so you have a very clear idea of what you intend to achieve with each interviewee at each interview.

The interview basics

A list of questions needs to be prepared, and the qualities and attitudes being sought for the vacancy being interviewed for need to be clarified.

Many interviewers use a checklist to guide them during interviews. This is a list setting out areas such as personal appearance, hobbies and interests, long range goals, personal ideas as to how to improve XYZ, or how to achieve ABC, and the applicant's manner.

In addition, prior to each interview, those conducting the interview must ensure they have:

- Notified each applicant well in advance of where and when the interview is to be conducted. This may have to be negotiated with the applicant especially where they are already employed by someone else, so flexibility, discretion and tact is needed
- Informed candidates of what they need to bring with them such as originals of photocopied submissions/certificates, samples/photos of work, additional references
- Pre-read the applicant's original submission together with any reports generated by others involved in the selection process (regarding possible need for practical tests, further telephone or other checks, queries to be raised during the interview, or perceived anomalies with a resumé requiring clarification)
- Re-read the job description and job specification for the job in question so as to be familiar with what is required and to ensure the thinking of the interviewers is not out of date with reality, or out of synch with the stated requirements of the position
- Re-read the Key Selection Criteria
- Arrange for a quiet, undisturbed, comfortable, non-threatening environment in which to conduct the interview
- Where a panel interview is to be used, determine who will take various roles in the interview. Work out who will welcome the candidate, who will introduce the other members on the panel, who will ask which questions, who will go first and who will close the interview.

The interview – preliminary formalities

When the scheduled time for a candidate's interview has arrived, or when the candidate arrives for their interview, standard practice is to:

- Greet the applicant. This must be done to demonstrate you are pleased to see the person. Body language is obviously very important, and what you actually say at this stage may also have been planned in advance in order to send the right message. It is vital this greeting does not send the message you are rushed, upset or under any sort of other pressure.

Smile and if appropriate offer your hand to shake hands with the candidate. Always be prepared for the candidate to offer their hand (many have been advised to do this by those who seek to help them gain a job) so keep your right hand free

- Put the applicant at ease. Your timing of the interview should allow a minute or two to provide some time for the interviewee to settle down and adjust to the strange surroundings of an interview situation.

The candidate needs a moment to sum you up (you do not want them distracted when you are conducting the interview) so you might consider offering tea or coffee in this space, or even engaging in some small talk about the weather

- Introduce yourself and all the other people on the interview panel. Make sure you do this clearly and without rushing. It is important the candidate hears what you are saying and understands who the panel are.

You should give people's names and their position and areas/levels of responsibility within the business together with a quick word as to why they are part of the interview team.

The names you use when introducing these people, and when introducing yourself, (that is, whether you use first names, or surnames) should indicate the tenor and formality of the interview.

The interview proper

No successful interview ever occurs without the appropriate planning so hopefully you will never get to this stage unless and until all the necessary preparations have been made. You need to be clear about the position being interviewed for, the candidate's application has been pre-read and the questions to be asked at interview have been crafted and readied.

With the interviewee has been introduced to those who will conduct the interview and feels settled, the actual interview can begin.

During the body of the interview it is suggested you apply the following techniques. You should feel free to fine-tune these to suit your individual personality, the nature of the position being interviewed for and your personal preferences (usually based on what has, and has not worked for you in the past).

The basics for a successful interview during the 'interview proper' are:

- Show the applicant you are familiar with their application and background by reference to their application form and resumé. It is usual to compliment them on some aspect of their achievement or their application, experience or qualifications

- State what the purpose of the interview is. Options may include obtaining more in-depth information to use as the basis for final selection, or fleshing out areas not fully addressed in a previous interview, or to gauge their interest in and commitment to a certain area. A quick review of the job description can be successfully used to achieve this.

This part of the interview is also the usual time to ensure the candidate is aware of any non-negotiable aspects, or 'challenging' parts, of the job (such as pressure, the physical aspect of the role, or the nature of the computerised reservation system or food ordering system used). Even where this information has been provided in job advertisements, on the application form or selection criteria it is important it is repeated here.

It may also be appropriate to provide a brief history of the organisation to help 'set the scene' for the interview. This can include a very brief outline of things such as where the business is heading and the scope and nature of proposed expansion

- Check the applicant is legally entitled to work. This is an important part of the process as you do not want to waste time or money (or risk committing an offence) by hiring someone who is not legally entitled to work
- When asking questions to the candidate, be direct and clear but try to avoid closed questions (those which can be answered with a simple 'yes' or 'no'). Ask plenty of the 'how' and 'why' type questions which get the interviewee talking

Your questions should have been designed to gain specific insight into areas of 'concern' identified as part of the shortlisting process. For example, there may be unexplained gaps in their employment history (why weren't they employed for that period?), they may have changed jobs every four months (why have they changed jobs so often?). These questions should focus on the applicant's personality, ability, skills and suitability for the position

- Where you require specific answers to questions do not be afraid to restate your question if you fail to get a direct answer, or to obtain the type of answer you expected. Also be on the lookout for any reluctance to respond directly to questions especially where previous work and/or working relationships are concerned
- Remember to keep quiet. When you have asked a question let the applicant answer it and listen to what they say: do not rush them and never finish their sentences for them.

Do not interrupt. Many interviewers see interviews as an opportunity for them to talk and/or to show off their knowledge and position, and this is to be avoided.

The intent of the interview is to get the *applicant* talking, and to find out about them

- Try not to unfairly influence the applicant's answers by giving off hints as to your personal preferences, prejudices or bias. The intention is to identify the applicant's thoughts and attitudes, not to get them to modify their opinions to accord with your personal beliefs
- Take notes if you believe this is a useful thing to do. Some people believe it only serves to make the applicant nervous, but many feel it is the only way to accurately record answers which are uncovered and the only way to obtain a useful record of events for later reference and decision making after the interview

- Do not adopt a dominating position during the interview. The applicant is nervous enough without being made to feel more uncomfortable by obvious signs of evident authority. Take care about your voice (avoid being too loud, or domineering). In addition:
 - Do not stand while the applicant sits
 - Do not have them looking into the sun while you have your back to it
 - Do not ignore them while they talk by attending to paperwork, adding up figures, or reading the newspaper
- Follow what you have designed and prepared as the pre-determined structure of the interview. Cover all the topics identified yet remain flexible enough to follow up any matters requiring extra attention.

It is good practice to make sure all applicants are asked the same standard battery of questions, even though certain applicants may be asked additional ones

- Encourage the applicant to clarify questions they are unclear about, and provide a time for them to ask questions of their own. Remember the interview is a two-way thing. Not only are you interviewing them but they are also working out whether or not they want to become your employee.

Closing the interview

When the plan for the interview has been achieved (that is, all the questions have been asked, and answered) you will need to close the interview.

The closing of the interview should also be planned and must 'flow' as part of the overall structure of the interview. It should never just abruptly stop.

Always keep an eye on the time allocated for the interview to avoid situations where the scheduled interviews start running late.

Techniques for closing the interview will depend on what has already been covered during the interview. Many interviews 'blow off course' during the discussion and several points can be addressed out of sequence.

Techniques to assist closing the interview can include:

- Asking the applicant if they have any further questions. Do this in a way that demonstrates you are encouraging them to do so
- Asking when the applicant is available to begin work if hired. It is advisable to ask this question of all candidates to prevent the applicant getting false hopes of being hired
- Seeking commitment from the applicant in terms of the tenure of the job. This requires a question seeking confirmation from the candidate they are willing and able to work the term required for the position

- Asking applicant about pay expectations. This may be appropriate in some interviews and not in others. In some interviews, your plan may have already included a statement on your behalf regarding the pay the position attracts so you may ask whether or not this pay rate meets their expectations.

In many cases (with the exception of some managerial staff and employees who have rare and much needed skills) pay rates are commonly offered on a 'take it or leave it basis'.

There is usually little or no room for pay negotiation but this should be addressed on a case by case basis, and you must be aware of any limitations applying to your ability to make a financial commitment on behalf of the organisation. It may be that management or the payroll department are the only ones authorised to negotiate remuneration

- Letting them know what will happen next. They should be informed as to when they will be notified about how they went, and how they will be notified.

You may also advise them if you require them to undertake any further selection processes such as a trade/practical tests or a medical examination – see next Section for more detail

- Confirming their contact information even though you will have a resumé from the applicant, people do relocate and they do lose phones and change phone numbers.

It is useful to verify at this stage that you have their current contact details. Where the candidate is currently working with another employer it can also be beneficial to clarify whether or not it is appropriate for you to contact them at work

- Thanking them for their time in attending the interview. This demonstrates respect for their effort and is obviously the polite and correct thing to do. You should have already determined whether or not you will offer to shake hands with applicants as they leave.

3.6 Apply relevant testing procedures

Introduction

Standard procedures in some businesses for nominated vacancies require successful applicants to undertake relevant testing before they are hired.

This section identifies what may be involved in this style of testing.

Why test and what tests are used?

There is a great difference between businesses in relation to the tests they apply to job applicants.

Some organisations apply no testing at all, and others require a standard test (or series of tests) for every candidate who has passed the interview process regardless of who they are, the position they are applying for, their age, their background or industry experience.

Reasons for testing

Tests are conducted for two main reasons:

- To determine competency levels. These are the 'trade' or 'technical' tests designed to identify skills and, if necessary, the need for on the job training, upskilling or top-up training.

These tests are conducted in the business, using workplace equipment, items and ingredients. Tests are observed by workplace staff/management who produce a written or verbal report on the skills of the individual.

Tests require the applicant to demonstrate one or more aspects of the job they are applying for in order, most commonly, to prove they have skills they have claimed.

In some organisations, applicants are paid for their time when they undertake these mandatory tests

- To prove the health of the applicant. These are standard medical tests where the applicant is sent to a medical practitioner to have relevant tests conducted.

Medical testing may be applied to identify any pre-existing injury or health condition, and/or to verify the applicant's fitness for work.

A written report is provided by the medical practitioner to management.

Types of tests

One or more of the following tests may be conducted:

- Drug and alcohol tests. More and more businesses are screening employees to identify if they are affected by drugs or alcohol.

Companies using this approach often have a 'zero tolerance' policy meaning any positive result means a potential job offer is withdrawn.

Psychometric testing (or 'profiling') is being used by an increasing number of employers as part of their selection process in an attempt to ensure they hire staff who have a personality compatible with the job they have to perform.

Alternatively, some employers will select their employees *first* and *then* apply the test (which is effectively a 'personality test') to identify the staff member's characteristics so they are better able to match their communication style to the preferences of the worker.

The tests have to be administered by suitably trained personnel and there is a fee payable for each test conducted, regardless of the result and regardless of whether or not you hire the person.

Commonly used personality profiling tests include Myers-Briggs and DISC.

These tests can be conducted at different levels to identify different things (such as intellectual intelligence, emotional intelligence, communication styles, teamwork).

Employers variously use personality testing to:

- Gain an understanding of the individual by better appreciating the person's strengths and weaknesses and their potential

- Provide a basis for the style of training delivery that best suits the individual allowing training to be delivered in a form that is most likely to be effective with the individual
- Enable informed predictions to be made about how a person is likely to respond and react to various situations. This may include identifying whether or not the person would operate well under pressure, if they can work without supervision or if they are likely to cope in an emergency
- Determine the potential the person has for extra responsibilities and/or promotion within the organisation
- Assist individual staff to improve their existing skills such as enhancing the quality of their relationships with others and helping identify action that needs to be taken to address identified weaknesses
- Identify motivation techniques that will work best with individual people – not all staff are motivated by the same thing
- Determine who should be allocated tasks, roles and responsibilities that need to be allocated.

3.7 File application and interview documentation

Introduction

After interviews have been conducted and/or testing has occurred, various internal processing and filing activities may occur.

This Section looks at the issues involved in filing application and interview documentation.

This Section should also be read in conjunction with section 4.1.

Filing of application documentation

Always follow house policies and/or established workplace practice when filing application documentation.

You may be required to:

- Create a file for each vacancy that has been interviewed for. This may be a suspension file in a filing cabinet
- Create a separate file for each candidate interviewed. This may be a manila folder for each applicant
- Write on the cover of each manila folder information about the contents of the file such as:
 - Name of the applicant
 - Name of every document contained in the file , for example:
 - Application form
 - Resumé
 - Names of copies of certificates accompanying the application
 - Date application received

- Create and/or update a register of applications. This provides an overview of the names of applicants and the number of applications received and can be used to decide whether or not the vacancy needs to be re-advertised before interviews are conducted or people selected.

Privacy and confidentiality are two main issues which must be addressed when filing such material.

Filing of interview documentation

Always follow house policies and/or established workplace practice when filing interview documentation.

You may be required to:

- Convert 'application' files to 'interviewed' files. This means the file created for applicants are re-used and turned into post-interview files. Doing this may include:
 - Culling files of those who were not interviewed:
 - Returning to applicants
 - Shredding
 - Sending letters of 'Thanks and Regret'
 - Retaining and converting files of all those who were interviewed regardless of whether they received a job offer or not. This is what is meant by keeping an application 'on file'
- Identify new documents added to the file on the cover of the file. These documents may include 'Interview rating sheets' from the interview process as completed by interviewers.

It is common practice in many establishments for all notes made during the actual interviews to be filed for future reference.

These notes may be required to guide future deliberations, but may also be useful as reference/source material if an unsuccessful applicant alleges impropriety or lodges an appeal with authorities

- Update files as required such as when results of tests and reference checks have been completed
- Maintain the file according to house policy, that is, keeping the file for a nominated time period.

Privacy and confidentiality issues must be addressed when filing such material.

Additional possible activities

When filing the above materials you may also be required to:

- Detail a list of all the 'Thanks and Regret' letters that were sent – who they were sent to, when and how they were sent
- Forward all applications that 'just missed out' to the Personnel department, or various department heads so a pool of potential staff for future use can be generated

- Photocopy and forward all the details and documents of the successful applicants to the Human Resources Department and/or the department manager for them to use as the basis for starting up an HR file for each new employee
- Notify all relevant departments as necessary regarding the employment of a new person so they can begin their work - for example, obtaining name badges, generating identity codes, obtaining uniforms, registering for induction and orientation.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 3.1 Provide evidence you have undertaken an interview for a nominated job vacancy at your workplace.

The interview may be an actual or simulated activity.

Your evidence must include a mix of photographic or video proof as well as documentation and a written report addressing:

- How applications for the position were accepted and processed
- The criteria used to shortlist applications including a relevant 'rating sheet' for the position
- Checking of both referees and references
- Notification to one applicant of their interview detailing time, date and location of the interview, the format of the interview and what the applicant is required to bring to the interview
- Planning and preparation activities prior to the interview
- The actual interview
- Written identification of at least one trade test that could be applied (Note: there is no requirement to provide evidence of this test being applied)
- Details of how application and interview documentation was filed for later reference.

Summary

Interview staff

When interviewing staff:

- File all applications in accordance with house policy
- Shortlist applicants on the basis of a reading of their application
- Only forward appropriate applicants for interview – that is, those who meet the minimum job requirements/KSC
- Advise unsuccessful applicants with a Letter of 'Thanks and Regret'
- Follow-up as required in response to issues arising with applicants, applications, recruitment agencies and/or other requirements
- Check references and/or referees in accordance with establishment protocols
- Schedule interviews by time, date and applicant name
- Advise short-listed applicants of time, date, location and nature of their job interview advising them of what to bring
- Plan and prepare for the job interview involving all those who will be involved in determining questions to be asked, roles for interviewers and other interview-specific issues
- Make the interview room ready
- Ready yourself for the interview by pre-reading or re-reading relevant material and familiarising yourself with KSC, rating sheet, job description
- Interview applicants in accordance with plans asking follow up questions as necessary and completing interviews on time
- Apply associated tests as necessary to help determine most suitable applicant
- File all application and interview materials for later use in accordance with house practice.

Element 4: Select staff

4.1 Choose successful applicant/s using pre-defined criteria

Introduction

Selection of staff to fill job vacancies should be based on picking the best staff for the job by comparing them to the predetermined key selection criteria for the position.

This Section identifies practices to help ensure the correct person is chosen for each job vacancy.

Making the decision about who gets the job

Best practice, not to mention EO requirements, demand you use the identified selection criteria as the basis for making all hiring decisions.

This stage involves:

- Comparing the applicant with the internally generated job analysis, description and specification, and assessing the relevant suitability of each applicant
- Reviewing the interview process and considering information obtained from the applicant, as well as opinions and impressions gained by the interviewers
- Rating the applicants into priority order - who would you prefer the most? Second-most? Remember your first choice may reject your job offer, may have got another job, or may be waiting for a better offer so it is always useful to pick your 'top three'
- Determining if an offer should be made to a candidate or if you should continue to interview and/or re-advertise the position.

Rating applicants

In order to obtain an objective perspective on all applicants many interviewers rate every applicant against the selection criteria giving them all a score out of, say, ten.

All the scores given to an applicant for each criterion are totalled and the one with the biggest score gets the job.

This rating scheme is usually a one page form attached (often as a cover sheet) to the file of the applicant (the manila folder forming the basis of the application for each candidate).

The file will contain the applicant's resumé plus any application form, covering letter and copies of any qualifications and references submitted. It may also contain notes made by those who have conducted reference checks.

This rating form (or a duplicate of it) could also be used during the actual interview process to help record the information you obtain from the applicant during the interview. They are useful as they help you compare 'like with like' by 'forcing' you to compare different people using the same reference points.

The higher the score an applicant gets on these sheets, the greater their chance of being hired. This approach can also be used to determine which applicants are shortlisted.

A sample rating sheet is presented below. It can, of course, be adapted to suit your individual circumstances and needs.



GRAND HOTEL INTERVIEW RATING SHEET					
Date of interview:	Job position:				
Interviewers:					
Location of interview:					
Name of person completing this form:					
Rating Criteria	Candidate 1 – Name: Out of 10	Candidate 2 – Name: Out of 10	Candidate 3 – Name: Out of 10	Candidate 4 – Name: Out of 10	Candidate 5 – Name: Out of 10
Personal presentation					
Industry knowledge					
Communication skills					
Qualifications					
Industry experience					
Attitude					
Transportation					
Can work unsupervised					
RSA certificate					
RSG certificate					
Gaming licence					
Has mobile phone					
Can work weekends					
TOTAL					

Using the above sheet as an example, let us say that 5 people were interviewed for a job as Gaming Room Attendant and after the interviews had been completed the rating sheets looked as follows:

GRAND HOTEL INTERVIEW RATING SHEET					
Date of interview: 04/04/2015		Job position: Gaming room attendant			
Interviewers: Sally Kilpatrick Bill Coit Catherine Grant					
Location of interview: Board room					
Name of person completing this form: Sally Kilpatrick					
Rating Criteria	Carla Young Out of 10	Betty Grey Out of 10	Will Williams Out of 10	Maureen Watts Out of 10	Nicole North Out of 10
Personal presentation	7	7	8	4	10
Industry knowledge	10	4	6	8	9
Communication skills	4	6	9	2	6
Qualifications	10	3	7	8	9
Industry experience	4	7	7	7	7
Attitude	8	6	3	8	9
Transportation	10	10	10	10	10
Can work unsupervised	5	6	7	8	9
RSA certificate	0	0	0	1	10
RSG certificate	10	10	10	10	10
Gaming licence	10	10	10	10	10
Has mobile phone	0	10	10	5	10
Can work weekends	0	10	10	0	10
TOTAL	78	89	97	81	119

The scores from the other two interviewers would be added to this sheet, but using the above form as a guide Nicole North would be offered the job, with Will Williams being the second choice if Nicole did not accept the job offer.

After the interview

Notes made during the interview

Where notes have been made during the interview, these should be reviewed. Usually, extra comment will be added on the basis of your existing feelings, reflections and observations.

Where panel interviews are being conducted it is best for panel members to complete and review their individual notes before they engage in discussion because the discussion may influence the notes they make.

The notes made should be included, along with the rating sheet, in the interview file (that is, manila folder) that has been created for each candidate.

These documents can provide a useful basis for reference in the future and also assist in selecting an alternate employee where the first person chosen for the job refuses the job offer made to them.

It is not all about qualifications and experience

It is worthwhile mentioning that when hiring staff, an important consideration (rarely stated but nonetheless factored into most hiring decisions) is whether or not the person being considered for the job will 'fit in' with the existing staff and with the organisation overall.

While this consideration is not, on the surface, a very detached or professional one it can be critical in terms of maintaining the unity and cohesion of existing teams and in preserving the 'happy and harmonious workplace' that already exists.

It may be counter-productive to hire someone who appears to be an excellent choice for the job but who upsets and annoys all the other staff, potentially creating management problems for you, causing other staff to leave and lowering both productivity and staff morale.

This means many interviews are conducted within an environment where interviewers are consistently asking themselves questions such as:

- "Could I work with this person?"
- "How will other staff get on with this person?"

4.2 Notify successful applicants and make formal job offer

Introduction

When all applicants have been interviewed, or otherwise assessed, it is usual to make an employment offer to the successful applicant(s).

This Section looks at what is involved in this part of the selection process.

Notifying successful applicants

A telephone call is the usual way to do this, followed by a formal 'Letter of Appointment'.

Any offers must accommodate the requirements of enterprise policies and comply with any applicable legal requirements.

Whilst it is common practice to notify all unsuccessful applicants as soon as possible after a hiring decision has been made, it is also common to keep the 'next best' two or three applicants in reserve in case your first choice does not take up your offer.

The Letter of Appointment

In addition to a verbal offer of employment, employers should provide the successful candidate with a written offer.

In some cases, this may be a draft work contract, but a Letter of Offer, or Letter of Appointment is also a popular option.

A draft work contract will align with existing workplace contracts, tailor-made for the individual position and is commonly prepared by the HR office/manager.

A Letter of Appointment should include information, such as:

- When the successful candidate is expected to commence their employment – a day, date and time
- The physical location where work is to commence naming the business, giving a street address and, where applicable, the name of a department where the person will work or attend for initial induction
- Identification of any award or agreement the person is to be engaged under so they understand their conditions of employment
- The job classification and employment status attaching to the position the person is being offered
- Details of any applicable probationary period – three months is a common term
- Entitlements relating to, for example, annual leave and sick leave
- Specified hours of work identifying, as appropriate, start and finish times and/or hours per week or fortnight, and/or shift work. A statement is often included indicating 'reasonable overtime' is to be worked
- Remuneration details specifying:
 - Pay per week, fortnight or hour

- Day on which wages are paid
- Method of payment for wages detailing if payment is made in cash, by cheque or via direct deposit into bank account
- Advice regarding legislated obligations such as superannuation, taxation and other issues
- A short-form job description providing the basic duties required by the position. This should reflect what was discussed at the interview
- A brief description of the main duties involved
- A date indicating when the offer is valid to and therefore when it expires, and when the offer will lapse
- Action the applicant needs to take in order to accept the offer.

Important points to note

- Only authorised personnel can make job offers. Official approval from management may be required before making an offer
- Management should read and approve Letters of Appointment before they are distributed
- A copy of the Letter of Appointment should be included in the relevant file for the applicant along with dates identifying when the Letter was given, and when the offer expires
- Details of the selection process must be kept private. Only those actually involved in the selection process should know how the choice of the successful applicant occurred
- Some organisations will allow the Letter of Appointment (or work contract offer) to be taken away from the workplace and some may not
- If the Letter of Offer is emailed or posted to the applicant it is a good idea to contact them to ensure they have received it. This is also an opportunity to respond to any queries the candidate may have.

4.3 Notify unsuccessful applicants

Introduction

Standard 'best practice' business practice is to notify applicants who have been unsuccessful in gaining employment.

This brief Section identifies possible issues involved in this activity.

Letter of Thanks and Regret

As mentioned, the most common method of notifying applicants they have not been successful in obtaining employment is to send them a Letter of Thanks and Regret.

This is a standard 'template' letter on company letterhead paper which usually contains the following:

- Date

- Thanks for the application
- Identification of the position applied for because some people can apply for multiple positions
- A statement advising in this instance their application has been unsuccessful. There is no reason given to explain why
- Further statements such as:
 - Encouragement in their job seeking activities
 - Encouragement to apply for other positions at the organization as they are advertised.

Some letters *may* also include a statement:

- Advising their application will be kept on file for future reference should a similar or other appropriate vacancy occur
- Offering a debriefing interview – see below.

De-briefing interviews

Very few businesses offer debriefing interviews to all job applicants because they take time and cost money.

In most cases they are not offered at all, to anyone.

Where they are offered they may be:

- Offered to all unsuccessful applicants. This is unlikely but certainly a good PR exercise and potentially beneficial where sufficient skilled staff are available as the interview can direct applicants regarding the skills and experience they need to gain before making another application
- Offered only to internal company staff who have applied, for example, for a promotion or for a change of job type/career
- Offered only to selected applicants based on their potential to be useful to the company in the future.

The debriefing interview will:

- Be conducted by one of the people on the interview panel
- Provide feedback on how the applicant presented and conducted themselves at the interview
- Provide advice regarding their CV and their response to the job vacancy advertisement and/or directions
- Provide tips and advice on how their next interview may be more positive
- Identify issues or questions not covered well by the applicant
- Encourage the person to continue applying for work
- Give advice on what they need to do to address identified gaps in their skills, knowledge or experience.

Unacceptable methods of notifying applicants

All company policies regarding notifying unsuccessful applicants as they apply to your workplace must be adhered to.

The following may apply:

- Email notification is approved in some businesses
- Telephone notification is usually not used as this can involve you in an argument with the applicant about why they were unsuccessful
- The use of texting/SMS is generally unacceptable.

4.4 Follow-up as required

Introduction

When a Letter of Appointment (or similar) has been sent to a successful applicant there can be a need to follow-up.

This Section identifies what may be involved in following up this situation.

Following-up

Generally speaking there is little required in terms of following up a Letter of Appointment.

In reality, the successful applicant will usually contact the organisation (as advised in the Letter) and necessary arrangements will be made when that contact occurs.

Follow-up may require you to:

- Check they have received the offer. There can be occasions when a letter goes astray
- Obtain original copies of documents presented at interviews so they can be photocopied and included in the Personnel file for the person.

Documents may include:

- Birth certificate
- Work permit/visa
- Qualifications, credentials and licences
- Explain details of the job offer, contract or other 'work instrument'. It is to be expected **every** successful job applicant will have questions of some sort about at least one or two aspects of their new employment.

This applies even to successful applicants who have previously worked at the business but are transferring to a new job or position

- Confirm acceptance of the job offer. This may:
 - Be an unconditional acceptance of what has been offered in the formal offer of employment
 - Require negotiation of terms, conditions or pay rates. It is important only those with the necessary authority are involved in these negotiations
 - Be a simple verbal acceptance

- Require the formal signing of a document, the Letter of Appointment or other employment instrument
- Require the signature to be 'witnessed' by a designated person within the employing workplace
- Require the signed document to be photocopied and:
 - Forwarded to Personnel/HR so they can initiate payment and other internal requirements applying to the engagement of new staff
 - Added to the existing Personnel file for the individual
- Offer the job to another applicant if the first choice of the selection panel or interviewer refuses the job offer.

This may entail:

- Contacting the interview panel for their advice about who to offer the job to
- Reviewing the interview rating sheets to identify the 'next best' applicant
- Obtaining permission to make the offer to a nominated person
- Producing or organising for an alternate Letter of Appointment, contract or employment instrument to be drafted. Changes may need to be made to an existing document in terms of:
 - Dates – starting date, date for accepting the offer
 - Name
 - Remuneration – the alternate candidate may be offered a higher or lower rate than first identified.

All other activities relating to the engagement of a new staff member will be covered during the formal Induction and orientation – see Element 4.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

4.1 Using your workplace (or another identified employer in the same industry/labour division) as a reference point prepare and submit a report on the staff selection process used providing:

- An explanation of the process involved in selecting the successful applicant for a position from a number of applicants
- Details of how the second-most successful and third-most successful candidate are identified as a result of the interview/selection process
- Information on the role of trade and other tests (where applicable) in determining the successful candidate
- Details of how successful candidates are informed they are to be made a job offer
- A sample Letter of Appointment
- A sample Letter of Thanks and Regret
- Details of possible follow-up activities when an offer has been made to the successful applicant.

Summary

Select staff

When selecting staff:

- Aim to choose the best person for each vacancy based on objective information about each applicant – use a rating sheet to ensure objectivity
- Observe legal requirements relating to EO in employment
- Take notes at the interview and compare thoughts of interviewers about each applicant
- Retain the names and details of suitable applicants until the preferred choice has accepted the job offer
- Notify unsuccessful applicants and process these notifications (and, where appropriate, other follow-up) in accordance with house protocols
- Issue a Letter of Appointment (or similar) to formalise all job offers
- Take action, as required, to follow-up after job offers have been made and/or accepted.

Element 5: Implement induction and orientation session or program

5.1 Plan the induction and orientation session/s

Introduction

It is standard business practice for all new employees to be given some form of induction program. These are also known as 'induction and orientation' programs or sessions.

This Section identifies planning activities and considerations for workplace induction and orientation.

Contents of the induction program

All the items listed below require some form of attention and planning in order for orientation to be effective and for them to give a positive impression to new staff on their first day with their new employer.

In organisations where induction and orientations are well-prepared and conducted on a regular basis, much of what is required will already be available and all you have to do is use what already exists.

Where little exists in the way of formal induction and orientation sessions you will need to organise and prepare much more.

Timing requirements

The amount of time allocated to Induction and Orientation sessions and programs varies enormously from 10 – 15 minutes through to a day or more in some larger premises.

The more planning and preparation that goes into these programs, the more effective they will be.

Certainly no effective induction program simply 'happens' of its own accord.

The longer the period for the induction and orientation, the more information will be included in the session so the more need there is for planning.

A familiar face

Whilst practicalities vary between establishments, it is a positive start to a new employee's association with your venue if someone present at the interview is there to welcome them on their first day.

This provides a familiar face to greet the new employee and demonstrates a personal interest in their welfare and in their association with the business.



OHS considerations

The majority of organisations conduct some form of formal Induction program for new staff.

This is done to allow operators to discharge their legal obligations in relation to informing staff about potentially dangerous situations/procedures and relevant OHS requirements.

Basic OHS requirements covered as part of the Induction (and which may need to be arranged) can include:

- Provision of OHS policies and procedures
- Presentation and description of safe work practices
- Identification of the location of first aid kits, accident registers, fire extinguishers, evacuation plans and similar
- Explanation of OHS structures (committees and representatives) within the business.



Other considerations

An effective induction program will provide the new employee with all the information needed to allow them to function well within their new organisation in their designated position.

Also, in many respects, the induction session is a semi-socialising experience allowing new staff to get to know other staff members, as well as providing a great opportunity to present an overview of the organisation together with its history and aims, an outline of a working day for the position concerned, and explanation of the company's policies, rules and standard operating procedures.

The exact nature of what is presented will vary with each business, and with each job or position.

There is however a need to address the establishment-wide issues (policies and parking, company history and goals) for all positions, as well as the more departmental/job-specific areas which will cover the day to day operational aspects of individual jobs. This includes items such as where equipment and tools are kept, the best person to contact about stock, what to do if there is a complaint about service, and so on.

It is important for every induction program to be tailored to suit the needs of individual establishments, but the following aspects can be seen as comprising a good basis for any effective induction program and highlights the planning that needs to be done:

- Completion of necessary paperwork covering internal and legislative requirements, such as:
 - Offer of employment letter (if not already signed/completed)
 - Staff uniform form
 - Personal details form including identification of 'next of kin'
 - Bank account details form for payment of wages into the bank
 - Personal taxation form
 - Superannuation application form

- 'Need to know' information – names of key staff, location of toilets and change room, where staff can park their cars (and where they are not allowed to park), how to sign in at the beginning of work, where company policies and procedures are located.

This may require you to:

- Arrange access to workplace intranet
- Distribute copies of policies and procedures
- Hand out staff employee manual
- Tour of the workplace to show the extent of the business, the physical relationship of one area to another, and to allow the new staff member to become more aware about the total nature of the business.



Some businesses include a 'Tour Checklist' the new staff member ticks off as they visit certain areas of the property, to ensure they get to see all the necessary areas

- Meeting with managers/supervisors and co-workers to introduce the new member and enable them to put a face to the name
- Allocation of uniform and relevant badges – issuing of the name badge and uniform (or arranging for fitting/ordering of new uniform) so the new member begins to feel part of the team.

A copy of the 'staff uniform policy' may also accompany this, together with a sheet explaining the charges for replacement uniform items

- Detailed department/position induction explaining how the new staff member's role fits in with other roles in the business and how the department collaborates with other departments to achieve overall organisation aims. Also includes identification of where materials, utensils and other work requisites are located
- Expectations of the role – setting out what is expected from the employee by management, customers/guests and other staff
- Coverage of details in the relevant job description – explaining and clarifying aspects of the job as it applies to the individual.

This is a detailed, point by point coverage and explanation of the job further explaining the job that has already been briefly addressed during the interview process. This explanation is intended to highlight vital aspects of the job and every aspect considered important

- Distribution of a copy of roster so the new staff member knows when they are expected to attend for work, when their breaks are and which days are Rostered Days Off
- Distribution of a list containing establishment-based terminology. This can be a physical checklist to explain establishment-specific terms and in-house shorthand or accepted abbreviations.

For example, most businesses have organisation-wide abbreviations/terms and most also have, in addition, specific abbreviations/acronyms used by certain work positions

- A written explanation of the operation of the business. This may cover an explanation of the range of products and services offered, any future plans for expansion, an overview of the different markets serviced, presentation of customer profiles, a list of the hours of operation of different departments/services, how payment is accepted throughout the venue, and even terms of trade.

There is really no end to what can be covered here, and this list is very much something that grows and changes with the business

- Explanation of safety and security issues – notification of the emphasis the venue places on the safety and security of staff and customers, explanation of where first aid kits, fire extinguishers, fire blankets, alarms and evacuation plans are located.

This may also be accompanied by company policies on evacuations, robberies and other security and emergency situations

- Explanation of company benefits. An explanation of staff discounts available, opportunities for promotion within the company, training provided by the company and how to take advantage of it, together with the limits that apply in each instance
- Explanation of any workplace awards that may exist such as 'Employee of the Month', how to win it and what it consists of
- Information about performance appraisals if applicable – explanation and definition of what these involve, when they will take place, how they are administered, and what they are used for.

Presentation is important in this regard and explanation of any KPIs the employee will be evaluated against. These could include revenue generated, number of rooms serviced, number of people served, number of meals served or other indicators appropriate to the individual job role.

When new staff members start their work, it is common to allocate them a person to be their workplace mentor/coach. This will be an experienced staff member who they can turn to for advice, information, guidance and further information.

Preparing work-specific information

Reference was made above about the need to provide information specific to the position into which the new employee is being inducted.



This information and detail should relate specifically to the tasks the new staff member is expected to undertake. The following is what may be appropriate for a food waiter who is being inducted and is provided to indicate the extent of preparation necessary for a successful induction:

- How to take a reservation – including details required, how to determine if there is a vacancy, how to alter a reservation
- Welcoming a guest – including standard approved phrases and terminology
- Seating a guest – how to do so, what to say while doing it, etiquette
- Greeting a guest at the table – introducing self, offering service, making recommendations

- Serving drinks – house rules about service
- Table clearing – showing the approved way of removing dishes, cutlery, glasses and other items from the table
- Maintaining fixtures and fittings – covering basic repairs and maintenance
- Preparing for service – showing and explaining the set-up procedures
- How to deal with a troublesome customer – including dealing with refusal of service
- Selling techniques relevant to the job – including (as applicable, suggestive selling, upselling, cross-selling)
- Basic product knowledge about menu items to support selling activities
- Telephone skills – standard telephone greetings, how to transfer a call, how to put a call on hold, how to take a telephone message
- Use of the establishment public address system
- Use of the ordering system for waiters – whether electronic or paper-based.



The new staff member should also be given basic 'product knowledge' relating to the property and to the products and services they will be dealing with.

The culture of the organisation

The culture of the organisation is generally described as representing 'the way we do things around here'.

It is important information for a new employee to help them 'fit in' with the workers who are already in the organisation.

This information may involve:

- Consideration and discussion of the Mission Statement of the business
- Explanation of the Vision Statement
- Explanation of company Values
- Description of the work ethic of the business
- Explanation of the 'grapevine' within the venue
- Identification of social opportunities (such as clubs) within the staff network.

Further considerations

When planning an induction for a staff member it is important to liaise with operational colleagues to ensure the induction is implemented in a manner minimising operational disruption.

Two common considerations relating to the timing of the induction for a new staff member are:

- The hour of the day the induction is to take place
- The particular day of the week the induction will take place.

This obviously has implications for determining the 'first day' for the new employee.

It is not a good idea – at least on most occasions – to conduct an induction at a busy time on a traditionally busy day.

When considering the implementation of any induction/orientation program, it is also necessary to pay due care and attention to:



- The smooth flow of information. It is important to run through the proposed induction session in your mind so as to check the flow of information to the new staff member.

Is there a readily understandable and sequential flow of information, or is the information being presented in a random, confusing and disjointed fashion?

- Allowing time for the new staff member to ask questions and clarify information. It must be remembered the induction and orientation program should be viewed as an opportunity for the new staff member to ask questions in order to clarify their issues and to find out further information they deem necessary.

An effective induction program will feature plenty of encouragement to the new person to ask questions, and plenty of time for their questions to be addressed

- Allocating adequate time for covering the essentials – a common problem with induction programs is they are often too rushed.

This can be a problem because a new staff member is not likely to complain or question being hurried through their first day at work. They will usually just keep quiet and learn nothing, hoping to pick things up as they go. Where this happens the induction really has been a waste of time and can even be regarded as counter-productive

- Ensuring the availability of key staff. This is a difficult thing to organise and very often will require the new staff member take several days to meet all the people seen as 'key' for their role. Given all staff have time off, other duties to perform, may be sick or on annual leave, it is not surprising few new staff get to meet all 'key' people on their first day.

The important point to bear in mind is you must identify who these key staff are, and then ensure they are introduced to the new person as soon as possible. This will often involve you in following up people many days after the initial induction to introduce them to others.

5.2 Conduct the induction and orientation session/s

Introduction

Your role may be to conduct induction and orientation for new staff.

This Section identifies important aspects of this task.

Practical considerations

Important things to consider when personally conducting induction and orientation sessions are

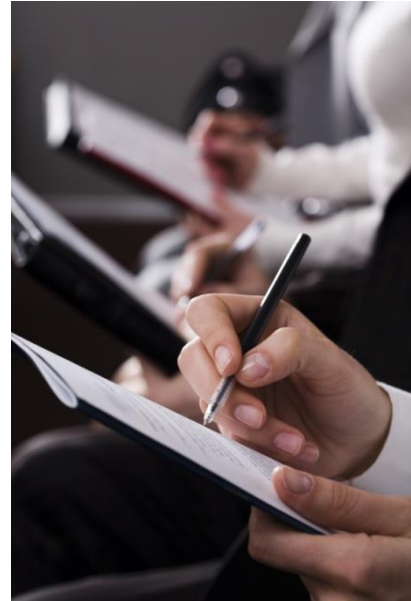
- Remember you only have one opportunity to make a positive impression in the mind of the new staff member.

Arrive early for the session and ensure all the necessary preparations have been made, and you have all the items you need to conduct an effective orientation.

One of the biggest mistakes is to arrive late for the session and keep the new staff member waiting beyond the advised starting time for the session. This immediately sends a poor message to them about how they are valued, and starts their relationship with the company on a negative footing

- Welcome the new staff member when they arrive for their induction and:
 - Introduce yourself where necessary
 - Try to make them feel at ease
 - Congratulate them on securing the job
 - Express appropriate sentiments:
 - You look forward to working with them
 - You expect a long and mutually beneficial relationship between the new staff member and the company
 - You anticipate their work will be rewarding, challenging and interesting
 - Explain what the induction and orientation will cover
 - Identify how long you expect the session to take
 - Encourage them to ask as many questions as they want
- Follow the plan. It is important to adhere to the plan developed for the induction and orientation session.

Departing from this plan raises the risk important information will be forgotten, and can also mean the new employee is provided with too much information and feels overwhelmed



- Given the need to follow the plan for the session, the person conducting the induction must be flexible.

If the plan is to enter a certain area and show the new person around, identify pieces of equipment and locate certain stock items, but there are an uncharacteristically large number of customers in the area and the staff are under obvious pressure, then the tour must be re-scheduled (even to a different day)

- Concentrate on the new employee – the focus of the session must be the new staff member.

Do not allow other things (telephone calls, other tasks, questions from other staff) to intrude and devalue the session

- Do not rush. Try to avoid giving the impression:
 - You have better or more important things to do
 - The induction session is an imposition or a chore
- Try not to drown the employee with information. It is easy for new staff to be overwhelmed by a mass of information. Stick to the plan
- Give personal insight in addition to 'structured' information. Give the new staff member the benefit of your experience and knowledge.



Make sure, of course, you say nothing negative about the business, its practices, staff or management

- Try to ensure privacy when you have to explain policies and practices, explain job requirements and expectations. Try to conduct these discussions in a location where there are no other people (staff or customers).

This encourages the new person to ask questions and respects their right to privacy

- Answer all questions asked honestly and comprehensively.

If you do not know the answer to a question, make a note of it, tell the person you will find out and get back to them. And then make sure you do

- Read through relevant documents with the new staff member to ensure they understand what is required. Important points should be emphasised
- Try to avoid group inductions and orientations. Group sessions may appear attractive in that they can save time but the reality is often certain members of the group are overlooked and/or do not receive proper attention or receive the necessary information.

Many group inductions are a waste of time and effort, serving no more useful purpose than 'ticking the box' that an induction has been provided

- Do whatever is appropriate to facilitate integration of the new employee into existing structures and the existing workforce. Show them the operation of the department/staff, explain and show what they are expected to do, personalise the experience

Ask for feedback on the contents of the induction and orientation program and on your performance in conducting it.

5.3 Review the induction and orientation session/s

Introduction

In the same way other activities of the business should be subject to regular review, so too should the provision of induction and orientation sessions.

This Section identifies what is involved in the review.

When should reviews occur?

Inductions and orientations should be reviewed:

- At least annually, and/or
- Following a valid complaint from a new employee about their induction and orientation, and/or
- Following the first induction and orientation session for a newly created position.



The key to reviewing induction and orientation sessions is to ensure appropriate action must be taken to address all legitimate needs and concerns.

There is no point conducting a review and then failing to act on the identified issues.

Who should be involved?

Reviews of induction and orientation sessions should involve all those involved in the session. In practice this means the review should solicit input from:

- Management
- Co-workers
- Supervisors
- Past inductees
- Anyone who conducts the induction and orientation.

What should be reviewed?

The review may focus on a particular issue or complaint but should also embrace:

- Planning and preparation – was there sufficient time and effort put into this phase of the induction? Often, a poor induction can be traced back to poor planning and preparation
- Time allocated – was there sufficient time allocated to actually conducting the induction? Or was it too rushed?
- Timing of the induction – was it conducted on the best day? At the most appropriate time, or at a time when things were too busy and key staff were unavailable because of this?
- Sequence of the induction activities. The correct items may have been addressed by the session but were items presented in the most effective order? Is there a need to rearrange some items to enhance learning and make the session more productive?

- Content of the induction session. Were all the necessary things covered? Were there gaps in the content provided needing attention so the new staff member is better informed and/or made aware of necessary (and perhaps, legislated) workplace requirements.

Content is a very large area for consideration as part of the review and should examine:

- Contents of documents provided
- Contents of speeches/talks given by key personnel to new staff
- Items/issues covered by the actual orientation and induction process.

Basic questions are:

- Were things missing?
 - Was printed material legible?
 - Have things changed in the workplace necessitating amendments to previous induction sessions?
 - Can unnecessary things be removed from the induction?
 - Should there be a different emphasis to existing content? For example, perhaps more time should be allocated to X and less time to Y
- Items handed out as part of the induction – were all the necessary items distributed? Were they current? Did they contain errors and/or were they incomplete?
 - Person conducting the orientation looking at whether or not the individual conducting these sessions is the right person for the job.

Many people believe conducting an induction session is beneath them and they begrudge doing them. This obviously does not make for effective or positive sessions.

- Feedback from participants. Anything a past inductee mentions as an issue for them should be considered.

Where there are *multiple* mentions of the same issue, certainly attention must be paid to this area.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 5.1 Provide evidence you have conducted a workplace induction and orientation session for an identified position.

The session may be a real or simulated session and you must provide evidence you:

- Planned and prepared for the session
 - Developed or obtained all necessary resources, materials, handouts to support a comprehensive and effective session
 - Introduced the 'new staff member' to relevant staff and explained all necessary work-related issues and workplace topics to them
 - Sought feedback from the 'new staff member' and identified aspects of the session that could be improved next time a similar session is undertaken.
-

Summary

Implement induction and orientation session or program

When implementing induction and orientation sessions or programs:

- Take the time and make the effort to plan and prepare for every session
- Ensure the induction reflects workplace and individual employee needs
- Make sure OHS considerations are addressed
- Prepare all necessary paperwork for distribution and/or completion
- Arrange a tour of the workplace and meetings with key staff
- Provide a roster, explanation of the company, details of the work required and expectations of the position
- Give or recap details of the position
- Conduct the actual orientation in line with the planning to the greatest extent possible
- Review induction and orientation sessions as part of the general reviews undertaken by the organisation.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organized. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognize and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

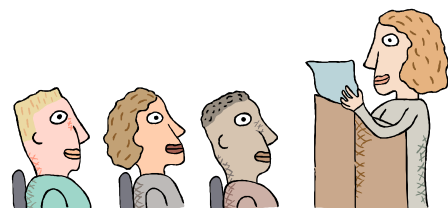
- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

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Trainee evaluation sheet

Recruit and select staff

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organized.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Recruit and select staff

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Identify staffing needs			
1.1	Obtain and read enterprise policies and procedures in relation to the staffing process	☐	☐
1.2	Identify internal factors that impact on staffing needs	☐	☐
1.3	Identify external factors that impact on staffing needs	☐	☐
1.4	Describe techniques to monitor workplace performance	☐	☐
1.5	Consult with stakeholders to determine staffing needs	☐	☐
1.6	Describe and quantify staffing requirements by position and locate them within an organisational chart	☐	☐
1.7	Undertake a job analysis of each identified position	☐	☐
1.8	Prepare job specifications and job descriptions for identified positions	☐	☐
Element 2: Recruit staff			
2.1	Identify and quantify positions to be advertised	☐	☐
2.2	Develop key selection criteria for each position to be advertised	☐	☐
2.3	Obtain authority to recruit staff	☐	☐
2.4	Identify sources of staff	☐	☐
2.5	Develop and lodge job advertisements/notices with identified sources of staff	☐	☐
Element 3: Interview staff			
3.1	Accept job applications	☐	☐
3.2	Short-list applicants	☐	☐
3.3	Check references and referees	☐	☐
3.4	Notify applicant of interview	☐	☐
3.5	Conduct job interview	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
3.6	Apply relevant testing procedures	☐	☐
3.7	File application and interview documentation	☐	☐
Element 4: Select staff			
4.1	Choose successful applicant/s using pre-defined criteria	☐	☐
4.2	Notify successful applicants and make formal job offer	☐	☐
4.3	Notify unsuccessful applicants	☐	☐
4.4	Follow-up as required	☐	☐
Element 5: Implement induction and orientation session or program			
5.1	Plan the induction and orientation session/s	☐	☐
5.2	Conduct the induction and orientation session/s	☐	☐
5.3	Review the induction and orientation session/s	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

